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GRAMIN DAK SEVAKS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020

Comprehensive Study Notes — LDCE / Departmental Examinations

Disclaimer:-

This study material has been compiled strictly from an examination-preparation standpoint for aspirants of LDCE (Inspector of Posts), PS Group 'B', and other postal departmental examinations. While every effort has been made to ensure complete accuracy and to incorporate the most recent statutory amendments, Office Memoranda and DG (Directorate General) instructions issued up to the date of this publication, students are strongly advised to cross-verify each provision with the original Office Memorandum / Gazette Notification before relying on any answer. Where any conflict arises between this material and the original Government order, the original Government order shall prevail.

Chapter 1 — Preamble and Definitions

Statutory Genesis

In supersession of the Department of Posts, *Gramin Dak Sevaks (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2011* — except as respects things done or omitted to be done before such supersession — the **Gramin Dak Sevaks (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020** were issued under the authority of the Government of India on **the 14th day of February, 2020**. These Rules constitute the principal instrument governing engagement, conditions of service, discipline, conduct and discharge of Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDSs) in the Department of Posts.

Rule 3 — Definitions

(a) *Gramin Dak Sevak — Categories of Post*

The expression "Gramin Dak Sevak" (GDS) covers three distinct categories of engagement under the Department of Posts:

S.No.	GDS Post	Description of Post
1	Branch Postmaster (BPM)	GDS working as Postmaster in a Branch Office.
2	Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM)	GDS other than BPM working in a Branch Office is designated as ABPM.
3	Dak Sevak	GDS other than BPM/ABPM working in Head Office, Sub Office or RMS Office.

(b) *Members of Family*

"Members of Family" in relation to a Sevak means:

- the wife, child or step-child of such Sevak (whether residing with him or not); and, in relation to a female Sevak, the husband residing with her and dependent on her; and
- any other person related to such Sevak (whether by blood or by marriage) or to such Sevak's wife or husband, and wholly dependent on such Sevak;

but the term does NOT include:

- a wife or husband legally separated from such Sevak;

- a child or step-child who is no longer in any way dependent upon such Sevak or of whose custody the Sevak has been deprived by any law.

Examination Note

Only a widowed daughter-in-law is included among "any other person related". A merely employed (financially independent) daughter-in-law residing in the same household does NOT fall within the definition.

Chapter 2 — Terms & Conditions of Engagement (Rule 3-A)

Working Hours and Age Limit

- A Sevak shall NOT be required to perform duty beyond a maximum period of **5 hours** in a day.
- A Sevak shall NOT be retained beyond **65 years** of age. Every Sevak shall furnish an undertaking that he/she has other sources of income besides the allowances paid by the Government — i.e., that adequate means of livelihood exist for himself/herself and his/her family.

Condonation of Irregular Retention Beyond 65 Years — Delegation of Power

Where a GDS has been continued in engagement beyond 65 years of age in error or irregularity, the following framework applies:

- **(i) Full recovery effected** — Where 100% of the overpaid allowances has been recovered from the GDS / officer at fault, the **Head of Region / Head of Circle** shall be competent to condone the overstayal of the GDS beyond 65 years.
- **(ii) Full recovery NOT possible** — Where 100% recovery is not feasible from the GDS / officer at fault, the **Head of Circle** shall be competent (in consultation with CIFA) to condone both the overstayal and the unrecovered amount of overpaid allowances.
- **(iii)** Necessary administrative / disciplinary action shall be taken against the officer or official found responsible for the over-retention of a GDS beyond 65 years of age.

Other Conditions of Engagement

- A Sevak can be transferred from one postal unit to another on grounds of public interest, vigilance or administrative necessity.
- A Sevak shall be outside the Civil Service of the Union.
- A Sevak shall NOT claim to be at par with Central Government employees.
- Residence in the post village / delivery jurisdiction of the Post Office within **one month** after selection but before engagement is mandatory. Failure to reside (place of duty for GDS BPM; delivery jurisdiction for other categories) after engagement shall be treated as violative of conditions of engagement and shall attract disciplinary action under Rule 10.
- The Post Office shall be located in accommodation provided by the GDS Branch Postmaster suitable for use as Post Office premises. Where, however, accommodation is provided by the Central / State Government / Local Government / Village Panchayat, the same shall be used for Post Office premises.
- Combination of duties of a Sevak shall be permissible.

Chapter 3 — Eligibility Criteria (Rule 3-B)

Age — Minimum & Maximum

The minimum and maximum ages for engagement to GDS posts shall be **18 years** and **40 years** respectively, reckoned as on the date of notification of the vacancy.

Permissible Age Relaxation

S.No.	Category	Permissible Age Relaxation
1	SC / ST	5 Years
2	OBC	3 Years
3	EWS	No relaxation
4	PwD / PH	10 Years
5	PwD / PH + SC / ST	15 Years
6	PwD / PH + OBC	13 Years

Persons belonging to Economically Weaker Sections (EWSs) who are not covered under the scheme of reservation for SCs, STs and OBCs shall be entitled to 10% reservation in engagement to GDS posts as prescribed in Directorate letter No. 17-09/2019 dated 26.02.2019.

All engaging authorities shall maintain the above age relaxation for persons with disability across all categories of GDS posts. This relaxation, however, is NOT applicable for persons with the benchmark disability "Blind"; in place of "Blind", candidates with "Low Vision" have been identified as suitable, vide Directorate letter No. 17-8/2017-GDS dated 26.02.2019.

Categories of Disability Suitable for GDS Posts (BPM / ABPM / Dak Sevak)

- (a) (LV) Low Vision
- (b) D (Deaf), HH (Hard of Hearing)
- (c) One Arm (OA), One Leg (OL), Leprosy Cured, Dwarfism, Acid Attack Victim, Both Leg (BL)*, Spinal Infirmary / Spinal Deformity without any associated neurological / limb dysfunction
- (d) Specific Learning Disability / Intellectual Disability
- Multiple disabilities from among (a) to (d) above — except Deaf-and-Blindness.

Categories of disability suitable for GDS engagement have been expanded to include Both Leg (BL)*, Spinal Infirmary / Spinal Deformity (without any associated neurological / limb dysfunction), and Intellectual Disability — in addition to the original listing under the 2020 Rules.

Educational Qualification

Secondary School Examination Pass Certificate of the 10th standard with passing marks in Mathematics and English as compulsory / elective subjects, conducted by a recognized board of Central / State / UT.

Compulsory Knowledge of Local Language

The candidate must have studied the local language at least up to the 10th standard (as a compulsory or elective subject), as declared by the State Government or as per constitutional provisions relating to the 8th Schedule of the Constitution of India, as prescribed by the Department from time to time.

Basic Computer Training

An undertaking shall be submitted by the candidate declaring that he/she has adequate knowledge to operate Computer desktop / laptop / PoS / mobile etc. to work on the Departmental software (vide OM No. 17-02/2018-GDS dated 11.05.2022).

Adequate Means of Livelihood

The selected candidate shall be required to comply with this prescribed condition within **30 days** after selection but before engagement. The GDS shall also ensure that he/she has adequate additional means of livelihood throughout the period of engagement till discharge.

Furnishing of Security

DELETED vide OM No. 17-02/2018-GDS dated 11.05.2022.

Method of Engagement

Engagement to all categories of GDS shall continue to be carried out through the online engagement process, as prescribed by the Department from time to time.

Exemption of Fee for Applying on GDS Posts

Male applicants belonging to UR / OBC / EWS categories shall pay a fee of **Rs. 100/-**. Payment of fee is exempted for ALL female candidates, ALL SC/ST candidates, ALL PwD candidates, and Transwomen candidates.

Adequate Representation of SC / ST / OBC / PwD / EWS

Instructions issued vide OM No. 19-11/97-ED & TRG dated 27.11.1997 (SC/ST/OBC), OM No. 17-08/2017-GDS dated 26.02.2019 (PwD) and OM No. 17-09/2019-GDS dated 26.02.2019 (EWS) shall continue to apply for adequate representation of these communities in engagement to GDS posts.

Production of Category Certificate

Production of SC / ST / OBC / Disability / EWS certificate in the prescribed format shall be compulsory in the case of candidates claiming engagement under the relevant category.

Chapter 4 — Job Profile of GDS Categories

(i) Branch Postmaster (BPM)

The Job Profile of a Branch Postmaster includes managing the affairs of the GDS Branch Post Office, IPPB operations, and ensuring uninterrupted counter operation during the prescribed working hours using the handheld device / smartphone supplied by the Department. The BPM is responsible for the overall management of postal facilities, maintenance of records, upkeep of the handheld device, ensuring online transactions, marketing of Postal and IPPB services, and procurement of business in the villages or Gram Panchayats within the jurisdiction of the Branch Post Office. The BPM is the team leader of the GDS Post Office and bears overall responsibility for smooth and timely functioning, including mail conveyance and delivery. The BPM may be assisted by an ABPM of the same Branch Post Office, and shall perform combined duties of ABPMs as and when ordered. The BPM is also required to undertake marketing, organize melas, business procurement, and any other work assigned by IP / ASP / SPOs / SSPOs / SRM / SSRM, etc.

Work performed for IPPB shall NOT be included in the calculation of TRCA, since the same is being remunerated on an incentive basis.

(ii) Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM)

The Job Profile of an ABPM includes sale of stamps / stationery, conveyance and delivery of mail at doorstep, deposits / payments / other transactions under IPPB, and assisting the BPM in counter duties using the handheld device / smartphone. The ABPM shall undertake marketing, organize melas, business procurement, and any other work assigned by the BPM or IP / ASP / SPOs / SSPOs / SRM / SSRM, etc. ABPMs shall also perform combined duty as BPM when ordered.

(iii) Dak Sevak

The Job Profile of a Dak Sevak includes sale of stamps and stationery, conveyance and delivery of mail, and any other duties assigned by the Postmaster / Sub-Postmaster — including IPPB work in Departmental Post Offices and RMS. The Dak Sevak shall assist Postmasters / Sub-Postmasters in the smooth functioning of Departmental Post Offices, undertake marketing and business procurement, and any other work assigned by the Postmaster, IP / ASP / SPOs / SSPOs / SRM / SSRM, etc.

Chapter 5 — Voluntary Discharge Scheme (Rule 3-C)

All categories of GDS may avail the Voluntary Discharge Scheme on completion of **20 years** of engagement period, or on medical grounds, as per the instructions issued by the Department from time to time.

Scheme-1: Voluntary Discharge on Completion of 20 Years

- **Minimum qualifying engagement period:** 20 years
- **Age:** No age restriction.
- **Notice period:** 3 months.
- Request can be withdrawn prior to acceptance of notice, with the approval of the accepting Authority, i.e., the Divisional Head.
- The Divisional Head is the competent authority to accept and approve the voluntary discharge for all categories of GDS.
- Compassionate engagement shall NOT be available to the dependents of a GDS who voluntarily discharges under this Scheme.
- **Entitlements:** Normal discharge benefits proportionate to the period of engagement rendered. If a GDS quits before completion of 20 years of engagement, he/she shall NOT be entitled to any monetary benefits under the Scheme.

Scheme-2: Voluntary Discharge on Medical Grounds

Scope: This option is intended for those who suffer on account of any contagious disease, or bodily or mental infirmity, which permanently incapacitates them for engagement.

Recent Order — VDS on Medical Grounds (OM No. 19-19/2024-GDS dated 25.02.2025)

The Voluntary Discharge Scheme for GDSs on Medical Grounds — earlier issued vide OM No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 14.12.2018 — has been comprehensively revised vide OM dated 25.02.2025. The Scheme is now intended for those who suffer on account of any contagious disease or bodily or mental infirmity which permanently incapacitates them for engagement as GDS. The revised Scheme also serves as the operative reference for compassionate engagement of dependents of GDS discharged on medical grounds (read with Addendum-IV to the Compassionate Engagement Scheme 2023, also dated 25.02.2025).

Option (A) — GDS does NOT wish to quit

No authority shall dispense with or reduce the TRCA of a GDS who suffers a permanent incapacitating condition:

- If a GDS, after acquiring a disability, is not suitable for the post he/she was holding, he/she shall be shifted to some other post — irrespective of its TRCA level — that is suitable for discharge of his/her duties as a GDS.
- If it is not possible to adjust the GDS against any post (keeping in view the nature of the disability), he/she may be kept on a *supernumerary post* until a suitable post is available or he/she attains the age of **65 years** — whichever is earlier.

Option (B) — GDS opts to quit GDS Seva permanently

Where a GDS who suffers a permanent incapacitating condition is neither willing to be shifted on any other post nor to be retained on a supernumerary post, he/she may quit Gramin Dak Seva permanently. The following Terms & Conditions shall apply:

- (i) An application for quitting Seva in the prescribed proforma shall be submitted by the GDS.
- (ii) If the GDS is not in a position to sign the application, it may be submitted on his/her behalf by the spouse or any other family member above **18 years** of age.
- (iii) On submission of the application, the GDS shall be directed by the Divisional Head (not below the rank of PSs Group 'B') to appear before the appropriate Medical Authority (i.e., Civil Surgeon, District Medical Officer, or Medical Officer of a Government Hospital) immediately, but not later than **15 days** from receipt of the application.

- (iv) The Medical Authority shall examine the fitness of the GDS. If found fit, fitness shall be certified accordingly. If not found fit, the Medical Authority shall certify that either: (a) the GDS suffers on account of a named contagious disease / bodily or mental infirmity which permanently incapacitates him/her for engagement as GDS; OR (b) the GDS is fit for further service of less laborious character than presently being performed.
- (v) A certificate so obtained from the Medical Authority without prior approval of the Department shall NOT be valid.
- (vi) Where the Medical Authority finds the GDS fit for further service or fit for less laborious work, the GDS shall NOT be allowed to quit and shall be offered an alternative post. Where the Medical Authority certifies the GDS as unfit, the competent authority shall accept the request forthwith.
- (vii) The Divisional Head is the competent authority to accept and approve the voluntary discharge for all categories of GDS. The date of effect is the date of acceptance of the request.
- (viii) The Scheme is purely voluntary; no GDS shall be compelled to quit under this Scheme.
- (ix) The Scheme shall NOT be available for a GDS under put-off duty, or against whom any disciplinary action / criminal action is pending or contemplated.
- **Minimum qualifying engagement period:** 10 years
- **Age:** No age restriction.
- Compassionate engagement shall NOT be available to dependents of a GDS who voluntarily discharges under this Option — UNLESS the medical-grounds conditions under Addendum-IV to the Compassionate Engagement Scheme 2023 (vide OM dated 25.02.2025) are satisfied (see Chapter 16).
- **Entitlements:** Normal discharge benefits proportionate to engagement rendered. If a GDS quits before completion of 10 years, no monetary benefits shall be admissible.

Chapter 6 — Engaging Authority and Powers (Rules 4 & 5)

Rule 4 — Engaging Authority

- (1) The Engaging Authority in respect of each category of Sevak shall be as shown in the Schedule annexed to these Rules.
- (2) If any doubt arises as to who is the appropriate Authority in any case, the matter shall be referred to the Director General (Posts), whose decision thereon shall be final.
- (3) Notwithstanding anything contained in these Rules, any authority superior to the Engaging Authority (as shown in the Schedule under Rule 31) may, at any time — either on its own motion or otherwise — call for records relating to engagements made by an Engaging Authority. Where such Engaging Authority appears (a) to have exercised a jurisdiction not vested in it; or (b) to have failed to exercise such jurisdiction; or (c) to have acted illegally or with material irregularity — the superior authority may, after affording an opportunity of being heard, make such order as it thinks fit, directing action under Rule 8 (Termination) or initiation of action to remove from engagement after following Rule 10 procedure (including orders for cancellation / rectification of the engagement process).

Rule 5 — Powers of the Engaging Authority

The powers of the Engaging Authority in the matter of awarding any of the penalties specified in Rule 9 may be exercised by an authority shown in the Schedule annexed to these Rules, or by any other authority empowered in this behalf by a special order of the Head of Circle or Head of Region, under circumstances to be recorded in writing.

PROVIDED THAT in no case shall the authority so appointed be lower in rank than the authority who originally engaged the Gramin Dak Sevak.

Chapter 7 — Pension, GDS Gratuity, Severance & SDBS (Rule 6)

Gramin Dak Sevaks shall NOT be entitled to any pension. However, they shall be entitled to GDS Gratuity, Severance Amount, or SDBS, as may be decided by the Government from time to time. (Substantive provisions are dealt with in Chapter 18.)

Legislative Note (Updated 2026)

For Gramin Dak Sevaks, the subscription towards the Service Discharge Benefit Scheme (SDBS) begins only after completion of one year from the date of joining.

Chapter 8 — Leave (Rules 7, 7-A & 7-B)

Rule 7 — Paid Leave

MAJOR RECENT AMENDMENT — Accumulation/Carry-forward of Paid Leave (OM No. 17-12/2025-GDS dated 30.12.2025; effective 01.01.2026)

Rule 7 of the GDS (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020 has been amended to introduce limited accumulation/carry-forward of paid leave WITHOUT encashment. The amended Rule 7 reads as follows:

Substantive provisions of amended Rule 7 (effective from 01.01.2026):

- Gramin Dak Sevaks may be granted paid leave at the rate of **20 days in a year (10 days for every half year)**.
- Paid leave of **10 days** shall be credited to the GDS's account at the beginning of each half-year, **starting on 1st January or 1st July**, as the case may be.
- A GDS shall be allowed to **carry forward unavailed paid leave to the maximum extent of 45 days at any given time**.
- Paid leave shall be credited to the leave account at the rate of **1.67 days for each completed calendar month** of engagement which the GDS is likely to render in a half-year of the calendar year of engagement / discharge / cessation of engagement.
- While affording credit of paid leave, **fractions of a day shall be rounded off to the nearest day**. A fraction of **0.5 or above** shall be taken as one day of leave; a fraction **below 0.5** shall be ignored.

Proviso to Rule 7

- (a) Where a Sevak fails to resume duty on the expiry of the maximum period of leave admissible and granted; OR

- (b) Where a Sevak granted leave for a period less than the maximum admissible remains absent from duty for any period which, together with the leave granted, exceeds the maximum admissible —

the Sevak shall — unless the Government, in view of the exceptional circumstances of the case, otherwise decides — be removed from engagement after following the procedure laid down in Rule 10.

Key takeaway — Encashment & Lapse

There is NO ENCASHMENT of paid leave under the amended Rule 7. The maximum accumulation cap is 45 days at any given time; any balance in excess of 45 days at the time of fresh half-yearly credit shall lapse.

Rule 7-A — Emergency Leave

Gramin Dak Sevaks shall be entitled to Emergency Leave for a maximum of **5 days in a calendar year**, or as prescribed by the Government from time to time. The GDS shall be paid TRCA as applicable during the period of emergency leave.

- Emergency leave is granted to a GDS to attend to any emergent / personal requirement.
- Not more than **two days** of emergency leave shall be granted at a time. No half-day emergency leave shall be granted. Emergency leave CANNOT be carried forward, encashed, or combined with paid leave.
- Sundays and Postal holidays falling during the period of emergency leave shall NOT be counted as part of emergency leave.
- Emergency leave shall NOT be granted to GDSs who are under put-off duty.
- When a GDS stays beyond **two days** of emergency leave at a time, the whole period shall be debited against his/her paid-leave account. If paid leave is not available, the excess period shall be treated as unauthorised absence and the GDS shall not be entitled to any TRCA.

Prior Sanction — Emergency Leave

- For BPM — Divisional Head.
- For ABPM / GDS — Sub-Divisional Head / Sr. PM / Unit Head.

- Unit Head — as per OM dated 16.09.2025, full power to grant leave to GDS is vested in SPM / PM at LSG / HSG-II / HSG-I / NFG levels.

Rule 7-B — Maternity Leave for Female GDS

A female GDS with less than two surviving children may be granted maternity leave by an authority competent to grant leave for a period of **180 days** from the date of its commencement, as per instructions issued by the Department from time to time.

Leave Without Allowance (LWA)

- GDSs, not being regular employees of the Government of India, are NOT covered under the Central Civil Services (Leave) Rules, 1972.
- GDSs are entitled to Leave Without Allowance (LWA). No allowance is payable for the period of LWA.
- LWA is in addition to other kinds of leave admissible to GDS (Paid Leave, Emergency Leave and Maternity Leave to female GDS).

S.No.	Category of GDS	Period of LWA in a Year	Sanctioning Authority
1	Branch Postmaster	Up to 60 days	Sub Divisional Head
2	Branch Postmaster	> 60 days and < 180 days	Divisional Head
3	ABPM / Dak Sevak	Up to 90 days	Sub Divisional Head or Head of Office (Appointing Unit)
4	ABPM / Dak Sevak	> 90 days and < 180 days	Divisional Head
5	All GDS	Beyond 180 days	Regional PMG / DPS

Chapter 9 — Termination of Engagement (Rule 8)

The engagement of a Sevak who has NOT already rendered more than three years' continuous engagement from the date of his/her engagement shall be liable to be terminated at any time by a notice in writing — given either by the Sevak to the Engaging Authority, or by the Engaging Authority (or any Authority to which the Engaging

Authority is subordinate, or any other Authority empowered in this behalf by the Government by general or special order) to the Sevak.

The period of such notice shall be **one month**. PROVIDED THAT the engagement of any such Sevak may be terminated forthwith, and on such forthwith termination the Sevak shall be entitled to claim a sum equivalent to the amount of Basic Time-Related Continuity Allowance plus Dearness Allowance admissible for the period of the notice (at the same rates as immediately before termination), or — as the case may be — for the period by which such notice falls short of one month.

Note 1

Where the intended effect of termination is immediate, it shall be mentioned that one month's TRCA plus admissible DA is being remitted to the Sevak in lieu of one month's notice through money order.

Note 2

When the engagement of a GDS is terminated under Rule 8, he/she shall NOT be eligible for GDS Gratuity and Severance Amount.

Chapter 10 — Nature of Penalties (Rule 9)

Minor Penalties [Clauses (1) to (5) of Rule 9]

- (1) Censure.
- (2) Debarring of a Sevak from appearing in the recruitment examination for Multi-Tasking Staff and/or Postman and/or Mail Guard, and/or from being considered for recruitment as Postal Assistant / Sorting Assistant, for a period **not exceeding 3 years**.
- (3) Debarring of a Sevak from being considered for recruitment to Multi-Tasking Staff on the basis of selection-cum-seniority for a period **not exceeding three years**.
- (4) Recovery from Time-Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA) of the whole or part of any pecuniary loss caused to the Government by negligence or breach of orders.
- (5) Withholding of annual increase in TRCA without cumulative effect for a period **not exceeding three years**.

Major Penalties [Clauses (6) to (9) of Rule 9]

- (6) Reduction to a lower stage in the TRCA slab for a specified period exceeding **three years** (not in the nature of a permanent measure), with further direction as to whether or not the Sevak will earn annual increase during the period of reduction and whether, on expiry of such period, the reduction will or will not have the effect of postponing the future increase of his/her TRCA.
- (7) Compulsory Discharge from engagement, with monetary benefits (i.e., SDBS, etc.) and GDS Gratuity proportionate to engagement period rendered by the GDS.
- (8) Removal from engagement — which shall NOT be a disqualification for future engagement.
- (9) Dismissal from engagement — which shall ORDINARILY be a disqualification for future engagement.

Chapter 11 — Disciplinary Procedure (Rule 10)

Rule 10-A — Procedure for Imposing Minor Penalty

No order imposing any of the penalties specified in Clauses (1) to (5) of Rule 9 shall be passed on a GDS except after —

- (a) The Sevak is informed in writing of the proposal to take action against him/her, and of the allegation on which the action is proposed to be taken, and is given an opportunity to make any representation he/she may wish to make; AND
- (b) Such representation, if any, is taken into consideration by the Engaging Authority.

Rule 10-B — Procedure for Imposing Major Penalty

No order imposing any of the penalties specified in Clauses (6) to (9) of Rule 9 shall be passed on a GDS except after —

- (a) The Sevak is informed in writing of the proposal to take action and of the allegation on which the action is proposed; AND
- (b) Such representation, if any, is taken into consideration by the Engaging Authority.

Rule 10-C — Record of Proceedings

The record of proceedings shall include —

- (i) A copy of the intimation to the Sevak of the proposal to take action;
- (ii) A copy of the statement of allegations, along with a list of evidence in support thereof, communicated to the Sevak;
- (iii) His/her representation, if any;
- (iv) The records of the inquiry proceedings along with the inquiry report of the Engaging Authority or Inquiry Officer, if any, appointed in a case where a formal inquiry is necessary;
- (v) The representation, if any, of the Sevak on the Inquiry Officer's report;
- (vi) Findings of the Engaging Authority in respect of the allegations; and
- (vii) The order imposing the penalty.

Rule 10-D — Mandatory Inquiry for Major Penalty

Inquiry has to be conducted EVEN IF the GDS accepts the charges in cases where a major penalty is to be imposed by the Engaging Authority. The purpose of holding an inquiry in such cases is primarily to give the GDS adequate opportunity to defend himself / herself. In case the charge is accepted by him/her UNCONDITIONALLY, there would obviously be no need for an inquiry for imposing major penalty.

Rule 10-E — Discretionary Inquiry for Minor Penalty

Normally, there is no need to conduct an inquiry for imposing minor penalty on a GDS. However, where a minor penalty is to be imposed under Rule 10, it is up to the discretion of the Disciplinary Authority to decide whether an inquiry should be held — particularly in the case of a request by the delinquent GDS received by the Disciplinary / Engaging Authority.

The implication of this rule is that, on receipt of the representation of the delinquent GDS on the imputations of misconduct / misbehaviour communicated to him/her, the Disciplinary / Engaging Authority should apply its mind to all facts, circumstances and reasons urged for holding a detailed inquiry, and form an opinion whether an inquiry is necessary.

Where the delinquent GDS has asked for inspection of documents and cross-examination of prosecution witnesses, the Disciplinary / Engaging Authority should apply its mind more closely to the request and should not reject the request solely on the ground that an inquiry is not mandatory.

If the records indicate that, notwithstanding the points urged by the delinquent GDS, the Disciplinary / Engaging Authority could — after due consideration — conclude that an inquiry is not necessary, it should record so in writing, indicating its reasons. Summary rejection of such a request, without any indication that the authority has applied its mind, may amount to denial of natural justice.

Rule 10-F — Procedure for Imposing Penalty After Discharge

Departmental proceedings under Rule 10, if instituted while a Sevak was in engagement, shall — after the discharge of the Sevak on attaining the age of sixty-five years — be deemed to be proceedings under that Rule, and shall be continued and concluded by the authority by which the proceedings were commenced, in the same manner as if the Sevak had continued in engagement. In such a case, the function of the Disciplinary Authority shall be only to reach a finding on the charges and to submit a report recording its findings to the President. The final decision on such report shall be taken in the same manner as in the case of review petitions of Sevaks addressed to the President, and no appeal shall lie against such decision.

The President reserves to himself/herself the right of withholding group insurance amount, security amount, post-engagement benefits like ex-gratia gratuity / GDS Gratuity and Severance Amount of a Sevak — by ordering recovery from these amounts — in case a Sevak is found guilty of grave misconduct or negligence during the period of his/her engagement.

For the purpose of this Rule, departmental proceedings shall be deemed to be instituted on the date on which the statement of charge is issued to the Sevak; or, if the Sevak had been put-off duty, on the date on which he/she had been so put-off.

Rule 10-G — Procedure for Disciplinary Proceedings After Discharge (Where No Proceedings Were Instituted Before Discharge)

(a) Departmental proceedings under Rule 10, if NOT instituted and the GDS is discharged on attaining 65 years — and his/her terminal benefits have not been released on the ground that departmental proceedings were proposed to be instituted — shall be instituted after the discharge of the Sevak. Such proceedings shall be deemed to be proceedings under Rule 10, and shall be continued and concluded by the authority by which they were proposed. The function of the Disciplinary Authority shall be only to reach a finding on the charges and submit a report to the President; the final decision shall be taken in the same manner as in the case of review petitions, and no appeal shall lie against such decision.

(b) PROVIDED THAT departmental proceedings, if not instituted while the GDS was in engagement before his/her discharge —

- (i) Shall NOT be instituted save with the sanction of the President;
- (ii) Shall NOT be in respect of any event which took place more than **four years** before such institution; and
- (iii) Shall be conducted by such authority and in such place as the President may direct, and in accordance with the procedure applicable to departmental proceedings in which an order of dismissal from engagement could be made in relation to the GDS during his/her engagement.

(c) The President reserves to himself / herself the right of withholding security amount, post-engagement benefits (GDS Gratuity, Severance Amount) of a Sevak by ordering recovery in case the Sevak is found guilty of grave misconduct or negligence during the period of his/her engagement.

For the purpose of Rule 10-G

- (i) Departmental proceedings shall be deemed to be instituted on the date on which the statement of charges is issued to the GDS / discharged GDS, or — if the GDS had been placed under Put-Off Duty from an earlier date — on such earlier date; and
- (ii) Judicial proceedings shall be deemed to be instituted: (a) in the case of criminal proceedings, on the date on which the complaint or report of a police officer (of

which the magistrate takes cognizance) is made; and (b) in the case of civil proceedings, on the date the plaint is presented in the Court.

Rule 11 — When Provisions of Rule 10 Shall Not Apply

- (i) Where any penalty is imposed on a Sevak on the ground of conduct which has led to his/her conviction on a criminal charge; OR
- (ii) Where the Authority empowered to dismiss or remove a Sevak is satisfied that — for reasons to be recorded by that authority in writing — it is not reasonably practicable to hold such an inquiry; OR
- (iii) Where the President is satisfied that in the interest of the security of the State it is not expedient to follow the procedure prescribed in Rule 10. In such cases, the Engaging Authority may consider the circumstances of the case and make such orders thereon as it deems fit.

Chapter 12 — Put-Off Duty (Rule 12)

The Engaging Authority, or any authority to which the Engaging Authority is subordinate, or any other authority empowered in this behalf by the Government (by general or special order), may put a Sevak off duty —

- Where a disciplinary proceeding against him/her is contemplated or is pending; OR
- Where a case against him/her in respect of any criminal offence is under investigation, inquiry or trial.

Special Provision — Fraud / Embezzlement Cases

In cases involving fraud or embezzlement, a Sevak holding any post specified in the Schedule to these Rules may be put off duty by the Inspector of Post Offices or the Assistant Superintendent of Post Offices of the Sub-Division — under immediate intimation to the Engaging Authority.

Where the IP / ASP of the Sub-Division is NOT the Engaging Authority, an order made by them shall cease to be effective on the expiry of **15 days** from the date of such order,

unless earlier confirmed or cancelled by the Engaging Authority or the Authority to which the Engaging Authority is subordinate.

Ex-Gratia Compensation During Put-Off Duty

A Sevak shall be entitled to ex-gratia compensation equal to **25% of his/her TRCA** together with admissible Dearness Allowance per month for the period of put-off duty.

PROVIDED THAT, where the period of put-off duty exceeds **90 days**, the Engaging Authority (or the authority to which it is subordinate, or any other authority empowered in this behalf) — being the authority that made the order of put-off duty — shall be competent to vary the amount of compensation for any period subsequent to the first 90 days.

Variation of Ex-Gratia After 90 Days

- **INCREASE** — by a suitable amount, not exceeding **50% of compensation admissible during the first 90 days**, if — in the opinion of the said authority — the period of put-off duty has been prolonged for reasons (recorded in writing) NOT directly attributable to the Sevak.
- **REDUCE** — by a suitable amount, not exceeding **50% of compensation admissible during the first 90 days**, if — in the opinion of the said authority — the period of put-off duty has been prolonged for reasons (recorded in writing) directly attributable to the Sevak.

Special Provisos

- A Sevak who has been absconding or remains absent unauthorisedly — and is subsequently put off duty — shall NOT be entitled to any compensation as ex-gratia payment.
- In the event of departmental proceedings initiated against a GDS (who was placed under put-off duty) for imposition of a major penalty finally ending with the imposition of a minor penalty, the Sevak shall be paid full TRCA and allowances for the period of put-off duty.

Condonation of Breaks Due to Put-Off Duty

The Head of Region / Head of Circle (where Regional PMG is not available) shall be empowered to condone the breaks caused due to the put-off duty period preceding reinstatement — in consultation with RIFA or CIFA (as the case may be) — in the following scenarios:

- (i) Imposition of minor penalty on the GDS in the Departmental proceedings; OR
- (ii) Exoneration in the Departmental proceedings / acquittal in criminal cases by Courts of law.

The powers of condonation of put-off duty period — in case of imposition of major penalty in Departmental proceedings, or where the GDS is convicted by a competent court of law — shall be exercised by the Head of Circle in consultation with CIFA.

Upon condonation of breaks by the competent authority, the periods condoned shall NOT be reckoned for the purpose of calculation of any terminal benefits.

Chapter 13 — Appeal, Revision & Review (Rules 13–20)

Rule 13 — Appeal

- A Sevak may appeal against an order putting him/her off duty to the authority to which the authority passing the order is immediately subordinate.
- A Sevak may appeal against an order imposing any penalty specified in Rule 9 to the authority to which the authority imposing the penalty is immediately subordinate.

Rule 14 — Period of Limitation for Appeal

No appeal shall be entertained unless it is submitted within a period of **three months** from the date on which the appellant receives a copy of the order appealed against, PROVIDED that the Appellate Authority may entertain an appeal after the expiry of this period if satisfied that the appellant had sufficient cause for not submitting the appeal in time.

Rule 15 — Form and Contents of Appeal

- (1) Every Sevak submitting an appeal shall do so SEPARATELY and in HIS/HER OWN NAME.
- (2) The appeal shall be addressed to the authority to whom the appeal lies under Rule 13; shall contain all material statements and arguments on which the appellant relies; shall not contain any disrespectful or improper language; and shall be complete in itself.

Rule 16 — Submission and Withholding of Appeal

Every appeal shall be submitted to the authority that made the order appealed against. That authority may withhold the appeal if —

- (i) It does not comply with any of the provisions of Rule 15; OR
- (ii) It is not submitted within the period specified in Rule 14, and no cause is shown for the delay; OR
- (iii) It is a repetition of an appeal already decided, and no new facts or circumstances are adduced.

PROVIDED that an appeal withheld on the SOLE ground of non-compliance with Rule 15 shall be returned to the appellant, and — if resubmitted within **one month** thereafter, after compliance with the said provisions — shall not be withheld.

- Where an appeal is withheld, the appellant shall be informed of the fact and the reason therefor.
- At the commencement of each quarter, a list of the appeals withheld during the previous quarter — together with the reasons for withholding — shall be furnished by that authority to the Appellate Authority.

Rule 17 — Transmission of Appeal

- (1) The authority which made the order appealed against shall, without any avoidable delay, transmit to the Appellate Authority every appeal which is not withheld under Rule 16, together with its comments thereon and the relevant records.

- (2) The Appellate Authority may direct transmission of any appeal withheld under Rule 16; thereupon, such appeal shall be transmitted along with the comments of the authority withholding the appeal and the relevant records.

Rule 18 — Consideration of Appeal

The Appellate Authority shall consider —

- (a) Whether the procedure specified in these Rules has been complied with;
- (b) Whether the findings are justified; AND
- (c) Whether the penalty imposed is excessive, adequate or inadequate — and pass orders —
 - (i) setting aside, reducing, confirming or enhancing the penalty;
 - (ii) remitting the case to the authority which imposed the penalty (or to any other authority) with such direction as it may deem fit;

PROVIDED that no order imposing an enhanced penalty shall be passed unless the appellant is given an opportunity of making any representation against such enhanced penalty.

Rule 19 — Revision

(1) Notwithstanding anything contained in these Rules, the following authorities may — at any time, either on their own motion or otherwise — call for the records of any inquiry / disciplinary case and revise an order made under these Rules, reopen the case, and after making such inquiry as considered necessary, may (a) confirm, modify or set aside the order, or (b) pass such orders as deemed fit:

- (i) Regional PMG — for GDSs working in a region headed by PMG; and in the rest of the cases, the Head of the Circle / Chief Postmaster General.
- (ii) Any other authority immediately superior to the authority passing the orders;
OR
- (iii) Any other authority specified in this behalf by the Government by general or special order, within such time as may be specified.

PROVIDED that no such case shall be reopened under this Rule after the expiry of **six months** from the date of the order to be revised — except by the Government, or by the

Head of Circle, or by the Postmaster-General (Region); and also **before the expiry of the time limit of three months specified for preferring an appeal under Rule 14.**

(2) NO application to revise an order made on an application for revision, or order passed or made on a revision, shall be entertained.

Rule 20 — Review

The President may, at any time — either on his/her own motion or otherwise — review an order passed under these Rules when any new material or evidence (which could not be produced or was not available at the time of passing the order under review, and which has the effect of changing the nature of the case) has come, or has been brought, to his/her notice.

Chapter 14 — GDS Conduct Rules (Rules 21–29A)

Rule 21 — General

Every Sevak shall at all times —

- (i) maintain absolute integrity;
- (ii) maintain devotion to duty; and
- (iii) do nothing which is unbecoming of a Sevak.

Rule 21-A — Promptness and Courtesy

No Sevak shall —

- (i) in the performance of his/her official duties, act in a discourteous manner;
- (ii) in his/her official dealing with the public or otherwise, adopt dilatory tactics or willfully cause delay in disposal of the work assigned to him/her.

Rule 21-B — Prohibition of Sexual Harassment of Working Women

- (1) No Gramin Dak Sevak shall indulge in any act of sexual harassment of any woman at any workplace.
- (2) Every Sevak who is in charge of a workplace shall take appropriate steps to prevent sexual harassment of any woman at such workplace.

Explanation — Definitions

(a) "Sexual Harassment" includes any one or more of the following acts or behaviour (whether directly or by implication):

- (i) physical contact and advances; OR
- (ii) a demand or request for sexual favours; OR
- (iii) making sexually-coloured remarks; OR
- (iv) showing pornography; OR
- (v) any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature.

(b) The following circumstances, among others, if occurring or present in relation to or connected with any act or behaviour of sexual harassment, may amount to sexual harassment:

- (i) implied or explicit promise of preferential treatment in employment / engagement;
- (ii) implied or explicit threat of detrimental treatment in employment / engagement;
- (iii) implied or explicit threat about her present or future employment / engagement status;
- (iv) interference with her work, or creating an intimidating / offensive / hostile work environment for her;
- (v) humiliating treatment likely to affect her health or safety.

(c) "Workplace" includes —

- (i) any department, organization, undertaking, establishment, enterprise, institution, office, branch or unit which is established, owned, controlled or wholly / substantially financed by funds provided directly or indirectly by the Central Government;
- (ii) hospitals or nursing homes;
- (iii) any sports institute, stadium, sports complex, competition or games venue (whether residential or not) used for training, sports or other related activities;
- (iv) any place visited by the employee / GDS arising out of or during the course of employment / engagement (including transportation provided by the employer);

- (v) a dwelling place or a house.

Rule 22 — Taking Part in Politics and Elections

- (1) No Sevak shall be a member of, or be otherwise associated with, any political party or any organization which takes part in politics — nor shall he/she take part in, subscribe in aid of, or assist in any other manner any political movement or activity.
- (2) It shall be the duty of every Sevak to endeavour to prevent any member of his/her family from taking part in / subscribing in aid of / assisting in any other manner any political movement or activity which is — or tends directly or indirectly to be — subversive of the Government as by law established. Where unable to prevent such activity, the Sevak shall make a report to the Government.
- (3) If any question arises as to whether a party is a political party, or whether any organization takes part in politics, or whether any movement or activity falls within sub-rule (2), the decision of the Government shall be FINAL.
- (4) No Sevak shall canvass or otherwise interfere with or use his/her influence in connection with, or take part in, an election to any legislative or local authority.

Provisos to Rule 22

- (i) A Sevak qualified to vote at such election may exercise his/her right to vote — but where he/she does so, he/she shall give no indication of the manner in which he/she proposes to vote or has voted.
- (ii) A Sevak shall not be deemed to have contravened this Rule by reason only that he/she assists in the conduct of an election in due performance of a duty imposed on him/her by or under any law for the time being in force.

EXPLANATION: The display by a Sevak on his/her person, vehicle or residence of any electoral symbol shall amount to using his/her influence in connection with an election within the meaning of this sub-rule.

Rule 23 — Strikes

No Sevak shall resort to or abet any form of strike, coercion or physical duress in connection with any matter pertaining to his/her conditions of engagement or the engagement of any other Sevak.

Period of strike shall be treated as under —

- (i) The strike period shall result not only in deduction of TRCA for the period of absence during the strike, but ALSO in break in engagement on account of incitement, violence and sabotage. A GDS who resorts to such action violates Rule 23 and may also attract disciplinary action. The list of activities covered under "strike" is illustrative and not exhaustive.
- (ii) A GDS absent from engagement hours for participating in the strike shall NOT be entitled to draw TRCA, DA, bonus, paid-leave TRCA, etc.
- (iii) The strike period shall not be adjusted or regularised by grant of any kind of leave.
- (iv) If specifically ordered by the competent authority — after show-cause notice — on account of incitement, violence or sabotage, the strike period shall also result in break in engagement.
- (v) The strike period would not qualify towards engagement period for payment of GDS Gratuity / Severance Amount at the time of discharge.
- (vi) The strike period would not qualify towards engagement period for absorption of GDS against Multi-Tasking Staff posts on seniority basis.
- (vii) The strike period would not qualify towards engagement period for appearing in the LDCE for PA / SA / Postman / Mail Guard / MTS, etc.
- (viii) The above actions [(i) to (vii)] may also be taken without prejudice to any disciplinary action against such GDS.

Rule 24 — Criticism of Government

No Sevak shall — in any radio broadcast, in any document published in his/her own name or anonymously / pseudonymously / in the name of any other person, in any communication to the Press, or in any public utterance — make any statement of fact or opinion which:

- (i) has the effect of any adverse criticism of any current or recent policy or action of the Central Government or a State Government; OR
- (ii) is capable of embarrassing the relations between the Central Government and the Government of any State; OR

- (iii) is capable of embarrassing the relations between the Central Government and the Government of any foreign State.

PROVIDED that nothing in this Rule shall apply to any statement made, or views expressed, by a Sevak in his/her official capacity or in the due performance of duties assigned to him/her.

Rule 25 — Evidence Before Committee or Any Other Authority

- (1) Save as provided in sub-rule (3), no Sevak shall — except with the previous sanction of the Government — give evidence in connection with any inquiry conducted by any person, committee or authority.
- (2) Where any sanction has been accorded under sub-rule (1), no Sevak giving such evidence shall criticise the policy or any action of the Central Government or of a State Government.

(3) Nothing in this Rule shall apply to —

- (a) evidence given at an inquiry before an authority appointed by the Government, Parliament or a State Legislature;
- (b) evidence given in any judicial inquiry; or
- (c) evidence given at any departmental enquiry ordered by authorities subordinate to the Government.

Rule 26 — Unauthorised Communication of Information

No Sevak shall — except in accordance with any general or special order of the Government, or in the performance in good faith of the duties assigned to him/her — communicate, directly or indirectly, any official document or information to any Sevak or any other person to whom he/she is not authorised to communicate such documents or information.

EXPLANATION: Quotation by a Sevak (in his/her representation to the Engaging Authority / Head of Office / Head of Department / President) of, or from, any letter / circular / office memorandum / or notes in any file to which he/she is not authorised to have access — or which he/she is not authorised to keep in personal custody / for personal purposes — shall amount to unauthorised communication of information within the meaning of this Rule.

Rule 27 — Insolvency and Habitual Indebtedness

A Sevak shall so manage his/her private affairs as to avoid habitual indebtedness or insolvency.

A Sevak against whom any legal proceeding is instituted for the recovery of any debt due from him/her — or for adjudging him/her as an insolvent — shall forthwith report the full facts of the legal proceedings to the Government.

Rule 28 — Vindication of Acts and Character of Sevak

- (1) No Sevak shall — except with the previous sanction of the Government — have recourse to any Court or to the Press for the vindication of any official act which has been the subject matter of adverse criticism or an attack of a defamatory character.
- (2) Nothing in this Rule shall be deemed to prohibit any Sevak from vindicating his/her private character or any act done by him/her in his/her private capacity. Where any such action is taken, the Sevak shall submit a report to the Engaging Authority regarding such action.

Rule 29 — Canvassing of Non-Official or Other Outside Influence

No Sevak shall bring or attempt to bring any political or other outside influence to bear upon any superior authority to further his/her interests in respect of matters pertaining to his/her engagement under the Government.

Rule 29-A — Prohibition Regarding Engaging in Any Business Detrimental to the Business of the Post Office / IPPB

A GDS shall NOT engage in any activity with any outside agency which would be detrimental to the business or interest of the Post Office / IPPB.

Chapter 15 — Interpretation, Delegation & SEDA

Rule 30 — Interpretation

If any question arises relating to the interpretation of these Rules, it shall be referred to the Government, whose decision thereon shall be final.

Rule 31 — Delegation of Powers

The Government may — by general or special order — direct that any power exercisable by it under these Rules (except the power under Rule 30 and this Rule) shall, subject to such conditions as may be specified in the order, be exercisable also by such officer or authority as may be specified.

MAJOR RECENT AMENDMENT — Revised SEDA (OM dated 26.11.2025; in force with immediate effect)

The Schedule of Engaging Authority, Disciplinary Authority and Appellate Authority (popularly called "SEDA") for all categories of GDS — earlier issued vide Directorate OM dated 28.07.2020 — has been comprehensively revised under Rule 31 of the GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020. The revised SEDA applies to all categories of GDS with immediate effect from 26.11.2025. Disciplinary proceedings already initiated shall continue under the existing procedure, but penalties (if any) shall be imposed by the Disciplinary Authority as per the revised SEDA. Appeals against punishments already awarded shall continue to be decided by the Appellate Authorities under the pre-revised SEDA.

Revised SEDA — Authority Structure (Effective 26.11.2025)

Category 1 — GDS Engaged in Division / Unit / Independent Unit Headed by PSs Group 'B' and Above, Up to STS Level (Below JAG Level)

Includes: Postal, RMS, MMS, Foreign Post, PSD, Sorting Office, Mail Office, etc.

Authority Role	Authority
Engaging Authority	Head of Division / Unit / Independent Unit
Disciplinary Authority — for ALL penalties (i to ix)	Head of Division / Unit / Independent Unit
Disciplinary Authority — Minor Penalties (i to v) — Alt. 1	Sr. Postmaster / Dy. Chief Postmaster / Supdt. (Sorting) or equivalent, for GDS in their own office

Authority Role	Authority
Disciplinary Authority — Minor Penalties (i to v) — Alt. 2	Postmaster not below HSG-I (Postal Side) for GDS in their own office
Disciplinary Authority — Minor Penalties (i to v) — Alt. 3	Sub-Divisional Head in Postal Division / Equivalent Officer in RMS Dn. / any other Office such as PSD, MMS, etc.
Appellate Authority — for ALL penalties (i to ix)	PMG (if no DPS Post in RO) / DPS Concerned / DPS Region
Appellate Authority — for Minor Penalties (i to v)	Head of Division / Unit / Independent Unit

Category 2 — GDS Engaged in Division / Unit / Independent Unit Headed by JAG Level and Above

Includes: Postal, RMS, MMS, etc.

Authority Role	Authority
Engaging Authority	Dy. Director (i.e. equivalent to JTS / STS) / Assistant Director level Officer (i.e. equivalent to PSs Group 'B')
Disciplinary Authority — for ALL penalties (i to ix)	Dy. Director (equivalent to JTS / STS) / Assistant Director level Officer (equivalent to PSs Group 'B')
Disciplinary Authority — Minor Penalties (i to v) — Alt. 1	Sr. Postmaster / Dy. Chief Postmaster / Supdt. (Sorting) or equivalent for GDS in their own office
Disciplinary Authority — Minor Penalties (i to v) — Alt. 2	Postmaster not below HSG-I (Postal Side) for GDS in their own office
Disciplinary Authority — Minor Penalties (i to v) — Alt. 3	Sub-Divisional Head in Postal Division / Equivalent Officer in RMS Dn. / any other Office such as PSD, MMS, etc.
Appellate Authority	Head of Division / Unit / Independent Unit

Consolidated Summary of Authorities by GDS Category (Working Reference)

S.No.	Post	Engaging Authority	Disciplinary Authority	Appellate Authority	Revision Authority	Review Authority
1	BPM	Divisional Head (Gr. 'A' JTS/STS or Gr. 'B')	Sub-Divisional Head (Minor 1–5) / Divisional Head (All 1–9)	Divisional Head / DPS (as per revised SEDA)	PMG / CPMG	President
2	ABPM	Sub-Divisional Head (ASP / IP)	Sub-Divisional Head (All 1–9)	Divisional Head (Gr. 'A' or Gr. 'B')	DPS	President
3	Dak Sevak	Sr. PM-Gr. 'B' / ASP / ASRM / IP / IRM	Sr. PM-Gr. 'B' / ASP / ASRM / IP / IRM (All)	Divisional Head	DPS	President

How to read the SEDA in the exam

(i) The Engaging Authority varies by the head-level of the Division/Unit (PSs Gr. B–STS vs JAG). (ii) The Disciplinary Authority is the SAME as the Engaging Authority for ALL penalties (i to ix). (iii) For MINOR penalties (i to v) alone, the Disciplinary Authority may also be exercised by the Sr. PM / HSG-I Postmaster / SDI in their own jurisdiction. (iv) The Appellate Authority moves up one rung: Category 1 → PMG/DPS; Category 2 → Divisional/Unit Head. Always remember 26.11.2025 as the effective date.

Chapter 16 — GDS (Compassionate Engagement) Scheme, 2023**Objective**

The objective of the Scheme is to grant engagement on compassionate grounds to one of the dependent family members of regularly engaged GDS / departmental employees — to relieve the family of such GDS / employee from financial destitution and to help it tide over the emergency.

Cases Where Compassionate Engagement May Be Granted

- (i) If the GDS or departmental employee passes away while in service, or has been missing for more than **two years**.
- (ii) If the GDS or departmental employee is compelled to permanently leave Gramin Dak Seva / service due to a contagious disease or physical / mental infirmity which renders them permanently unfit for engagement — provided the GDS is discharged on these medical grounds before attaining the age of **62 years**.

Compassionate engagement is NOT a matter of right and shall be subject to fulfilment of all conditions — including availability of vacancy — as laid down under the Scheme.

Note Provisions

- (i) Only ONE eligible dependent of the deceased GDS / departmental employee would be entitled to compassionate engagement as GDS.
- (ii) In the case of a departmental employee, one and the same eligible dependent may apply for appointment on compassionate grounds on BOTH (departmental vacancy AND GDS vacancy) as per the eligibility criteria and conditions prescribed under the relevant schemes. If selected against both, the candidate shall have to choose engagement / appointment in any one post, and quit / resign from the other on a permanent basis.
- (iii) **GDS discharged on contagious disease / bodily or mental infirmity:** As per Addendum-IV (OM No. 19-19/2024-GDS dated 25.02.2025), cases of GDSs who are allowed to quit GDS Seva permanently under the Voluntary Discharge Scheme on Medical Grounds are also covered under the Compassionate Engagement Scheme — provided the GDS is discharged on these medical grounds before attaining the age of **62 years**, and subject to fulfilling the other conditions in the OM dated 25.02.2025 (as revised from time to time).

MAJOR RECENT ORDER — One-Time Relaxation for Compassionate Engagement (OM No. 19-19/2024-GDS dated 30.12.2025)

To facilitate compassionate engagement of dependents of deceased Departmental Employees / GDSs whose deaths occurred between 01.01.2020 and 24.02.2025 (i.e., from the commencement of the COVID period to the date from which the provision for engagement of dependents of regular employees as GDS on compassionate grounds was formally

introduced), the Department has approved a one-time, time-bound relaxation. This relaxation is valid for ONE YEAR from the date of issuance — i.e., up to 30.12.2026. The two-year application time limit prescribed in the Revised Scheme (OM dated 14.06.2023) is relaxed for all eligible cases falling within this defined period. CEPT shall make necessary provision in the CCE portal under APT 2.0 for processing such cases.

Who Can Apply? — Dependent Family Member

"Dependent Family Member" means and includes:

- (a) Spouse;
- (b) Son — including legally adopted son / married son;
- (c) Daughter — including legally adopted daughter / divorced daughter / judicially separated daughter — wholly dependent on the GDS;
- (d) In the case of death of an unmarried GDS — unmarried brother or sister (unmarried / widow / divorced / judicially separated) wholly dependent on the GDS at the time of his/her death;
- (e) Widowed daughter-in-law of the deceased GDS — provided she gives an undertaking that she is not availing the same benefit from her own parenthood;
- (f) Widowed daughter of the GDS — provided she gives an undertaking that she is not availing the same benefit from her husband's parenthood.

Continuation After Re-marriage

A widow / divorced daughter or sister engaged on compassionate grounds shall be allowed to continue in engagement EVEN AFTER re-marriage.

Order of Priority

- (i) FIRST priority — Spouse of the deceased GDS. In such cases, only the consent of the spouse will be taken.
- (ii) SECOND priority — The dependent nominated by the spouse. In such cases, the consent of the spouse AND the nominated dependent shall be taken.
- (iii) THIRD priority — Where there is no spouse, or the GDS was unmarried at the time of his/her death, compassionate engagement may be given to any one of the dependent family members with the consent of all other dependents.

Competent Authority and Periodicity of CCE Meetings

- (i) Divisional Head / Head of Unit (PSs Group 'B' and above) shall be competent to make compassionate engagements on vacant GDS posts, based on the recommendations of the Committee on Compassionate Engagement (CCE) and prior approval of the Regional Director / DPS [HQ], as the case may be.
- (ii) All cases for compassionate engagement shall be considered by the CCE; recommendations shall be sent for approval to the Regional Director / DPS [HQ] (where the Division/Unit reports directly to the Circle Office).
- (iii) The CCE shall consist of 3 members for considering compassionate engagement of dependents of deceased GDS:
 - (a) Head of engaging Division / Unit (PSs Group 'B' and above)
 - (b) In case of Division: (1) Dy. SP / ASP / IP posted in Divisional Office who looks after compassionate engagement cases; (2) Senior-most Sub-Divisional Head of the Division concerned.
 - (c) In case of Units: one ASP / IP looking after compassionate engagement cases in the Unit AND one senior-most ASP / IP working in the Unit. In case of non-availability of ASP/IP in the unit, ASP/IP posted at the same station in other units/divisions may be co-opted.

The Committee shall meet QUARTERLY — i.e., in April, July, October and January — to consider cases arising during the previous quarter.

Timelines for Processing

Info & Documents to Family of Deceased GDS	Submission of Application by SDI to Divisional Head	Quarter of Application Receipt	Completion at Divisional Head	CCE Meeting & Minutes to RO/DPS (HQ) for DPS Approval by
Immediately after the death of GDS — not later than 7 days of the death of the GDS	Within 25 days of the death of GDS	January to March	April	15th May

Info & Documents to Family of Deceased GDS	Submission of Application by SDI to Divisional Head	Quarter of Application Receipt	Completion at Divisional Head	CCE Meeting & Minutes to RO/DPS (HQ) for DPS Approval by
		April to June	July	15th August
		July to September	October	15th November
		October to December	January	15th February

Minutes & Decision Timeline

Minutes shall be sent to Regional Director / DPS [HQ] for approval within 5 days of the CCE meeting. The Regional Director / DPS [HQ] shall convey his/her decision within 7 days from receipt of the CCE recommendation.

Verification Requirement

Where verification of educational certificates, caste certificates, police verification, etc., was not completed at the time of death of the GDS, family members of such deceased GDS will not be eligible for engagement on compassionate grounds till successful verification of all relevant / required documents.

Eligibility

(a) The applicant for compassionate engagement should be eligible as per the criteria prescribed for engagement of GDS in the GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020 (revised from time to time), and suitable for the post in all respects as per the conditions prescribed for normal regular selection.

Relaxed Criteria — Educational Qualification

If a dependent of the deceased GDS willing for compassionate engagement does not possess the requisite educational qualification at the time of submission of the application, he/she may still be considered for engagement to the post of Dak Sevak on PROVISIONAL basis, provided —

- (i) He/she shall be given up to a maximum of **3 years** to acquire the minimum required educational qualification for engagement as regular GDS.

- (ii) During provisional engagement as Dak Sevak, he/she will draw only the minimum TRCA (Level-1) applicable to Dak Sevak, and shall NOT be entitled to annual increment till he/she attains the requisite educational qualification.
- (iii) The engagement of such Dak Sevak shall be provisional and liable to be terminated as per provisions of Rule 8.
- (iv) In the event of not acquiring the minimum required educational qualification within the prescribed **3 years** from the date of provisional engagement, the provisional engagement shall stand automatically terminated.
- (v) Transfer of such provisionally engaged GDS shall NOT be considered under Rule 3 of GDS (C & E) Rules, 2020 till completion of **two years** from regularization of engagement.

Note-1

Age eligibility shall be determined with reference to the date of application — NOT the date of engagement.

Note-2

Head of Division / Unit shall keep a record of GDS engaged under relaxed criteria and shall be responsible for ensuring that such GDS are not continued in engagement after 3 years if they fail to acquire the requisite educational qualification.



Relaxation in Age

There shall be NO relaxation in the upper age for engagement on compassionate grounds. There shall, however, be NO upper age limit in respect of an applicant who is the spouse of the deceased.

Time Limits for Eligible Dependent — Submission of Application

- (i) Where an eligible candidate in the family wishes to apply, he/she shall submit the application in all respects to the IP / ASP of the Sub-Division / Unit at the earliest possible opportunity, but not later than **two years** from the date of death of the GDS.
- (ii) Where no one in the family is eligible, such member may apply for compassionate engagement within **two years** of attaining the requisite eligibility criteria.

Missing Gramin Dak Sevak

Cases of missing GDS are also covered under the Scheme, subject to the following conditions:

- (a) A request for compassionate engagement can be considered only after a lapse of at least **2 years** from the date from which the GDS has been missing, provided that —
 - (i) An FIR to this effect has been lodged with the police;
 - (ii) The missing person is not traceable and a police report to this effect is available;
 - (iii) The competent authority feels that the case is genuine;

(b) This benefit shall NOT be applicable to a GDS:

- (i) who had less than **two years** for normal discharge from service on the date from which he/she has been missing; OR
- (ii) who is suspected to have committed fraud, joined any terrorist organisation, or gone abroad.
- (c) Compassionate engagement of a missing GDS also is not a matter of right, and shall be subject to fulfilment of all conditions (including availability of vacancy).
- (d) While considering such a request, the result of the police investigation shall be taken into account.
- (e) The decision on such a request shall be taken at the level of the Head of Region / Head of Circle based on the recommendations of CCE.

Deceased GDSs Who Had Committed Frauds / Wrong-Doing While in Engagement

- (i) Dependent family members of a GDS against whom disciplinary / judicial proceedings were pending / contemplated at the time of death CAN be considered for compassionate engagement — as disciplinary proceedings stand abated on the death of the charged GDS.
- (ii) Where the deceased GDS was involved in moral turpitude / misappropriation of Government money and was awarded a major penalty other than removal / dismissal in the past, the dependent family member shall NOT be eligible for engagement on compassionate grounds.

Request for Change in Post / Person

- (i) Any request for change in post / person may be considered by the Competent Authority ONLY BEFORE joining of the dependent.
- (ii) The Competent Authority to consider change in post is DPS, and change in person is HOR / HOC.
- (iii) Once the dependent family member of the deceased GDS has been offered engagement on compassionate grounds, the circumstances that led to such engagement shall be deemed to have ceased to exist. Therefore — (a) he/she shall strive in his/her career like any other GDS for future advancement; any request for engagement to a higher post on compassion shall be rejected. (b) An engagement made on compassionate grounds CANNOT be transferred to any other person; any such request shall be rejected.

Seniority

The seniority of a person engaged as GDS on compassionate grounds shall be determined on the basis of his/her initial date of joining the GDS post; his/her position in the seniority list of GDS of the unit concerned shall be determined accordingly.

Chapter 17 — TRCA & Allowances

Time-Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA)

As per Directorate Order No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 25.06.2018 and letter No. 17-2/2018-GDS dated 22.03.2019, the following minimum TRCA shall be payable, as may be prescribed by the Government on the basis of workload / revenue norms as per the standard of assessment decided by the Department from time to time:

Sl. No.	Category	Minimum TRCA (4 Hours / Level 1)	Minimum TRCA (5 Hours / Level 2)
1	BPM	Rs. 12,000/-	Rs. 14,500/-
2	ABPM / Dak Sevak	Rs. 10,000/-	Rs. 12,000/-

In respect of GDSs engaged on or after **01.07.2018**, the initial fixation of TRCA shall be done on the first stage of Level 1 of the respective category.

Wage Scales (Kamlesh Chandra Committee Implementation)

- **Wage Scale-1:** ABPM / Dak Sevak (Level-1) — Rs. 10,000/-
- **Wage Scale-2:** ABPM / Dak Sevak (Level-2) / BPM (Level-1) — Rs. 12,000/-
- **Wage Scale-3:** BPM (Level-2) — Rs. 14,500/-
- **Fixation factor:** multiplication by 2.57.
- **Annual Increment:** 3% of TRCA.

Annual increase dates: **1st July or 1st January** of every year (whichever is applicable based on the date of engagement). A GDS is entitled to only ONE annual increase in TRCA in a calendar year.

Productivity-Linked Bonus / Ex-Gratia Bonus

Present calculation of ex-gratia bonus by applying the calculation ceiling of Rs. 7,000/- (basic TRCA + DA) shall continue until further orders.

Date of Effect — Revised TRCA

The revised TRCA as per the matrix for all GDSs is applicable w.e.f. 01.07.2018. The revised rates of other allowances also take effect from 01.07.2018.

Allowances at a Glance

Allowance	Rate
Office Maintenance Allowance (OMA) / Composite Allowance (BPM only) — Standard Accommodation	Rs. 500/- p.m.
OMA / Composite Allowance — Non-Standard Accommodation	Rs. 250/- p.m.
Fixed Stationery Charge (ABPM / Dak Sevak)	Rs. 25/- p.m.
Boat Allowance	Rs. 115/- p.m.
Cycle Maintenance Allowance	Rs. 180/- p.m.
Cash Conveyance Allowance — up to Rs. 1 Lakh	Rs. 30/- + actual conveyance (max. public-bus fare)

Allowance	Rate
Cash Conveyance Allowance — above Rs. 1 Lakh	Rs. 50/- + actual conveyance (max. public-bus fare)
Combined Duty Allowance — BPM for Delivery OR Mail Conveyance	Rs. 45/- per day (max. Rs. 1,170 p.m. = 45 × 26)
Combined Duty Allowance — BPM for Delivery PLUS Mail Conveyance	Rs. 90/- per day (max. Rs. 2,340 p.m. = 90 × 26)
Combined Duty Allowance — ABPM doing BPM work	Rs. 75/- per day (max. Rs. 1,950 p.m. = 75 × 26)
Combined Duty Allowance — ABPM/GDS for additional ABPM/GDS work	Rs. 45/- per day (max. Rs. 1,170 p.m. = 45 × 26)
Risk & Hardship Allowance (in identified areas per 7th CPC)	Rs. 500/- p.m.

Standard Accommodation for GDS Branch Office

- (a) Building owned by Gram Panchayat;
- (b) Building owned by Central / State Government (e.g. schools or offices);
- (c) BPM's own house;
- (d) Proper rented accommodation in a busy place of the village;
- (e) Building owned by NGOs.

Other essentials of accommodation:

- **Location:** The GDS Post Office should be located in the main busy part of the village.
- **Size:** Minimum size preferably 10 × 10 (i.e., not less than **100 sq. ft.**) on the ground floor.
- **Approach:** Direct access from village road; front portion of the building; NOT in verandas, courtyards, kitchen, under stairs, damaged rooms, makeshift arrangements, or isolated buildings outside the village.
- **Structure:** Preferably brick-mortar; properly ventilated, lighted, maintained and white-washed.

- **Power supply:** Electrical power connection for charging handheld devices, fans, bulbs; suitable place for solar panels.
- The accommodation shall be exclusively available for post-office use.
- A village shop may host the post office only if there is exclusive space for registers, micro-ATMs, signage and other items, giving due importance to the post office.

Children Education Facilitation Allowance (CEFA)

- Reimbursement may be claimed for the two eldest surviving children — with the exception that in case the second-child birth results in twin/multiple births. In case of failure of sterilisation operation, CEFA is admissible in respect of children born out of the first instance of such failure, beyond the usual two-children norm.
- Amount: **Rs. 6,000/- per annum (fixed) per child** — fixed irrespective of actual expenses incurred.
- Reimbursement has NO nexus with the child's performance — even if the child fails, reimbursement shall not be stopped. However, if the child is admitted in the same class in another school (already passed in the previous school, or mid-session), CEFA shall not be reimbursable.
- In case of discharge / dismissal / removal, CEFA shall be admissible till the end of the academic year in which the GDS ceases to be in engagement.
- Upper Age Limit: **22 years for Divyaang children; 20 years or passing of 12th class (whichever is earlier)** for other children. NO minimum age.
- Applicable from nursery to 12th standard (including 11th & 12th held by junior colleges or schools affiliated to Universities / Boards).
- Admissible for children studying through Correspondence / Distance Learning, subject to other conditions.
- Admissible for the initial **two years** of a diploma / certificate course from Polytechnic / ITI / Engineering College — if pursued after 10th and CEFA has not been granted for 11th and 12th.
- For a Divyaang child studying in an institution aided/approved by Central/State Govt./UT, or whose fees are approved by any of these authorities — CEFA shall

be reimbursed irrespective of "recognition". Benefit admissible till the child attains the age of 22 years.

- CEFA is admissible while the GDS is on duty / under put-off duty / on leave — except for any period treated as "non-counted for duty".

Chapter 18 — GDSGIS, Gratuity, Severance & SDBS

Gramin Dak Sevak Group Insurance Scheme (GDSGIS), 2010

- Insurance Amount: **Rs. 50,000/-**
- Premium: **Rs. 50/- per month**
- From **1st Oct 2021**, the subscription of Rs. 50/- comprises Savings Fund Rs. 32.50 and Insurance Fund Rs. 17.50 (ratio 65 : 35).
- Age: **19 to 50 Years**
- After retirement, the subscription with interest is payable to the GDS. In case of death / suicide, the amount of Rs. 50,000/- is payable to the nominee.

GDS Gratuity & Severance Amount

S.No.	Scheme	Existing Benefit	Revised Benefit
1	GDS Gratuity (earlier called Ex-gratia Gratuity)	Granted at the rate of half month's basic TRCA drawn immediately before discharge of service, for each completed year of service — subject to a max. of Rs. 60,000/- or 16.5 times basic TRCA last drawn, whichever is less.	Continuation of the existing formula, subject to a max. of Rs. 1,50,000/- w.e.f. 01.01.2016. Minimum Service: 10 Years.
2	Severance Amount	Rs. 1,500/- per completed year, max. Rs. 60,000/- subject to a GDS having completed 10 years of continuous service.	Rs. 4,000/- per completed year, max. Rs. 1,50,000/- subject to 10 years of continuous service, w.e.f. 01.01.2016. Applicable only to GDS who opted to remain with Severance and

S.No.	Scheme	Existing Benefit	Revised Benefit
			did not shift to SDBS. Min. Service: 10 Years.

Counting of Service Period

6 months and above shall be counted as ONE YEAR, and less than 6 months shall be IGNORED — for the purpose of calculation of total years in GDS Gratuity and Severance Amount.

Old Rate for Severance Amount (Effective 01.10.2009 — Historical Reference)

Nature of Benefit	Present (Pre-Revision)	Revised Benefit
Ex-gratia Gratuity	Half-month's basic TRCA × completed years; max. Rs. 18,000/- or 16.5 months basic TRCA last drawn (whichever less); min. service 15 years.	Existing formula continued, max. Rs. 60,000/-.
Severance Amount	Lump sum Rs. 30,000/- on discharge after 20 years of continuous service; Rs. 20,000/- if 15–20 years of continuous service.	Rs. 1,500/- per completed year, max. Rs. 60,000/-; min. eligibility reduced to 10 years.

Migration & Other Provisions — Gratuity / Severance / SDBS

- If an existing GDS remains with Severance (instead of opting for SDBS, 2011) and is later promoted to MTS / PM / MG / PA / SA, the Severance Amount will be paid in cash if 10 years of continuous engagement are completed. **Per latest clarification (Directorate Order No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 26.11.2024)**, a GDS who is absorbed on a regular post in the Department is NOT eligible for Gratuity.
- If a GDS who joined SDBS, 2011 is promoted to MTS / PM / MG / PA / SA, the Total Accumulated Pension Corpus under SDBS, 2011 (together with Severance Amount) shall be credited into NPS Tier-1 on migration from SDBS to NPS.
- If a GDS who joined SDBS, 2011 has engagement period of less than 10 years and is promoted to a departmental post, the Total Accumulated Pension Corpus along with Severance Amount shall be credited into NPS Tier-1.

- In case of death of a GDS, Severance Amount and Gratuity shall be paid to the nominee if the GDS completed 10 years of continuous engagement. If he/she joined SDBS, 2011, the accumulated fund is paid to spouse / nominee as per rules of exit of NPS-Lite.
- In case of death where the GDS has NOT completed 10 years of continuous engagement, Severance Amount and Gratuity shall NOT be paid to the nominee. If he/she joined SDBS, 2011, the accumulated fund is paid to spouse / nominee per NPS-Lite exit rules.
- 6 months and above counts as one year; less than 6 months ignored — for GDS Gratuity / Severance Amount calculation.

Service Discharge Benefit Scheme (SDBS), 2011

- The GDS Committee headed by Shri R. S. Natarajan Murti recommended introduction of SDBS in place of the existing Severance Amount Scheme.
- Came into existence: **01.04.2011**.
- The Scheme utilises the platform of NPS-Lite for registration, record-keeping and fund management.

Definitions (SDBS)

- **(a) Aggregator-cum-Account Officer:** GM (Finance), Postal Accounts & Finance / Director of Accounts (Postal).
- **(b) Collection Centre (CC):** Office of Director / Sr. Supdt. / Supdt. / Head of Postal Division.
- **(c) Custodian:** A company / agency responsible for holding assets of the NPS Trust. At present, Deutsche Bank AG is the Custodian on behalf of the NPS Trust.
- **(d) Oversight Offices:** Office of Director General, Department of Posts, New Delhi.
- **(e) PFRDA:** Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority of India.

Eligibility (SDBS)

- (a) All existing regularly engaged GDSs who have been selected after due process and rendered at least **one year of satisfactory service** are eligible to join. Subscription begins only after completion of one year from the date of joining.
- (b) Existing GDS who are due to be discharged within **3 years as on 01.01.2011** are not eligible to join.
- (c) The Scheme is MANDATORILY applicable to all GDSs engaged on regular basis under the prescribed Rules, on completion of one year of satisfactory service after the introduction of the Scheme.
- (d) Existing GDSs opting to continue under the Severance Amount Scheme shall continue under the existing terms and conditions without any linkage to SDBS.
- (e) For GDSs opting to join SDBS, the amount accrued since the date of joining the scheme @ **Rs. 1,500/- for every completed year of service** till enrolment under SDBS shall be added to the accumulated contribution in their Permanent Retirement Account at the time of Discharge / Death for annuitisation / utilisation.
- (f) Severance Amount for a period less than a year shall be calculated for the complete month on proportionate basis. A fraction of less than 15 days shall be ignored; 15 days or more shall be treated as a complete month.

Subscription (SDBS) — Current Rate

- (a) The Government of India (Department of Posts) shall subscribe @ **Rs. 300/- per month**, and an equal amount shall be contributed by the GDS, w.e.f. **01.07.2018**.

Legislative Note (Updated 2025)

Substituted for "Rs. 200/- per month" (Government contribution only) to an EQUAL contribution of Rs. 300/- from both Government and GDS, w.e.f. 01.07.2018.

- (b) No contribution / subscription shall be made by the Department in respect of a GDS during the period he/she is placed on "Put-Off Duty" or remains on unauthorised absence.

Appointment / Permanent Absorption in a Regular Departmental Post

On such absorption, the Scheme is exited and all accrued accumulations (together with any Severance Amount) shall be transferred to the new account under the National Pension System.

Exit from SDBS

(a) At the age of normal discharge from service (65 years):

- Lump-sum withdrawal: **60%**
- For purchase of annuity: **40%**

(b) Premature exit — after the age of 58 years and before 65 years:

- Lump-sum withdrawal: **20%**
- For purchase of annuity: **80%**

(c) Resignation from service: Permanent Retirement Account of SDBS shall be treated as closed:

- Lump-sum withdrawal: **15%**
- For purchase of annuity: **85%**

(d) Dismissal and Removal from service: The PR Account shall be treated as closed, and all accrued accumulations shall be FORFEITED.

Payment of Various Charges

All the charges shall be borne by the Department.

Chapter 19 — GDS (Financial Upgradation) Scheme, 2024 [GDSFU]

Title, Date of Effect & Applicability

- Title: **Gramin Dak Sevaks (Grant of Financial Upgradation) Scheme, 2024**
- Date of Effect: **15.03.2024**
- Applicability: All GDSs engaged on regular basis in accordance with the GDS (C & E) Rules, as amended from time to time.

Benefits Under GDSFU

GDSs shall receive a FIXED addition to TRCA per month on completion of specified continuous engagement periods. Dearness Allowance shall NOT be paid on this fixed addition, and the addition shall not count for grant of annual increase of TRCA.

Completed Continuous Engagement	Fixed Addition (per month)	Cumulative Addition (per month)
12 years (but < 24 years)	Rs. 360/-	Rs. 360/-
24 years (but < 36 years)	Rs. 460/-	Rs. 820/- (i.e. Rs. 360 + Rs. 460)
36 years or more	Rs. 600/-	Rs. 1,420/- (i.e. Rs. 360 + Rs. 460 + Rs. 600)

Continuous Engagement — Computation

- In determining the period of continuous engagement, the following periods shall be treated as break in engagement unless condoned by the competent authority:
 - (i) Unauthorised absence
 - (ii) Put-Off Duty Period
- In case of condonation of period of absence / put-off duty, the interruption shall not be construed as a break in continuous engagement (leading to retention of past service); HOWEVER, the condoned period shall NOT be counted towards determining the length of continuous engagement.
- In case of provisional engagement followed by regular engagement after completion of prescribed formalities / verification, the date of engagement shall be taken as the date of joining on the basis of the order of provisional engagement.

Screening Committee

- Members — 3 — Dy. SP / ASP (HQ) / Inspector.

Schedule of Screening Committee processing:

Activity	Maturing Cases — First Half (Jan to June)	Maturing Cases — Second Half (July to Dec)
Identification of eligible GDS & preparation of Special Report by Sub-Divisional Head / Unit Incharge (LSG and above)	1st April to 10th June	1st October to 10th December
Submission of list & Special Report by SDH / Unit Incharge to Divisional Head / Unit Head	15th June	15th December
Meeting of Screening Committee	1st week of July	1st week of January
Issue of Order	15th July	15th January

Schedule of Meetings

- The Committee shall meet TWICE a year — in the first week of January and the first week of July. Orders shall be issued on 15th January and 15th July.
- Orders for grant of financial upgradation by the Division / Unit Head shall be issued by 31st January / 31st July, as the case may be.

Guidelines for Screening Committee — Non-Recommendation

The Committee shall NOT recommend the benefits under the Scheme in the following circumstances:

- (i) Pendency of disciplinary / criminal proceedings;
- (ii) Put-off duty;
- (iii) Currency of any minor / major penalty other than "Censure".

Representation

A GDS aggrieved with the decision of the Screening Committee / Divisional Head regarding non-grant of financial upgradation may submit a representation to the next higher authority — i.e., DPS / DPS (HQ) / PMG / CPMG — within a period of **3 months** from such rejection.

GDS Working on Departmental Posts / APS / IPPB, etc.

GDSs working on Departmental Posts / APS / IPPB, etc., shall also be eligible for grant of benefits under the Scheme from the due date of completion of the requisite period of engagement. Their cases shall be considered by the Screening Committee in the regular course along with other cases. However, the addition to TRCA shall be allowed ONLY when they are repatriated to their original / alternative GDS post. NO arrears of accrued benefits shall be paid in such cases.

Chapter 20 — Substitute Arrangement & Limited Transfer Facility

Substitute Arrangement in Place of Regular GDS

Short-Term Vacancies	Long-Term Vacancies
Vacancies arising due to leave / medical condition of GDS, etc., up to 45 days.	Vacancies of more than 45 days caused due to any circumstance — including deputation, discharge, termination, etc.
Substitute should NOT be engaged against a short-term vacancy in any GDS post in routine manner. As far as possible, the work should be managed by combining duties.	Combination of duties may be restored, and a substitute may be allowed only if the workload of the BO as well as its financial position / revenue norms justifies such engagement / filling of the post at the BO on regular basis.
When combination of duty (stop-gap arrangement) is not possible, a substitute may be provided for not more than 45 days against any GDS post. The Sub-Divisional Head (SDH) is authorised to approve substitute arrangements for BPM / ABPM / Dak Sevak within the Sub-Division up to a period of 45 days.	Continuation of substitute arrangements beyond 45 days and up to a period of ONE YEAR at a stretch may only be allowed by the Divisional Head. A record of such arrangements shall be maintained in the Divisional Office, mentioning justification.

Further Limits & Review

- During the inspection of the Division, each case of substitute arrangement beyond 180 days shall be reviewed by the Inspecting Authority — specifically with

reference to the efforts made to fill the post through regular means. If any arrangement is found unjustified, the Inspecting Authority shall record its observations and refer the matter for the necessary orders of the Regional PMG / CPMG.

- On receipt of such a reference, the Regional PMG / CPMG shall issue necessary directions for continuation or otherwise within a FORTNIGHT.
- No substitute arrangement against any vacant GDS post shall be allowed to continue beyond ONE YEAR without the specific approval of the Head of Region (HoR) / Head of Circle (HoC). For continuation beyond one year, the Divisional Head shall submit a detailed proposal to the competent authority AT LEAST ONE MONTH IN ADVANCE of the completion of the one-year period, clearly justifying the need. If no communication (approval or observations) is received from the HoR / HoC within the stipulated time, the approval shall be DEEMED to have been granted.
- Practice of giving break for a few days and then again providing substitute for the same vacant GDS post is improper. The number of days shall be counted from the first day a substitute was provided.

Substitute — Sunday TRCA

Persons working as substitute of GDS may be paid TRCA for Sunday if they continuously work for 6 days. However, no extra payment on account of National Holidays will be made to such persons, in view of the fact that payment to GDS is made on monthly basis.

Limited Transfer Facility (LTF) — Conditions of Transfer

- Minimum engagement condition for transfer of GDS under LTF is revised from 'one year' to **TWO YEARS of continuous engagement**. A GDS who has completed a minimum of **2 years** of continuous engagement from the date of regular engagement as GDS — as on the last date for submission of online application in a particular cycle — shall be eligible to seek transfer under LTF.
- A GDS may apply for transfer against any or all vacant posts of GDS — as per eligibility, in order of preference — in any ONE Division at a time. Transfer is at the own cost of the GDS.

- Online request for transfer may be submitted as and when the window is opened. Generally, the GDS online transfer schedule is issued on a half-yearly basis, immediately before the GDS Online Engagement Cycles.
- Refusal to accept the Limited Transfer Order shall be counted as ONE chance of Limited Transfer availed. If the transfer application is withdrawn within the window period, the chance shall NOT be counted.
- Mutual Exchange facility is provided to all GDS on completion of **1 (one) year** from the date of regular engagement as GDS.
- Male GDS: **TWO chances** of LTF in entire career; female GDS: **THREE chances**. However, there shall be a 'cooling-off' period of **one year of continuous engagement between two successive transfers**.
- Transfer requests of GDS under put-off duty, or against whom any disciplinary action / police case / Court case is pending, shall NOT be entertained.
- Past engagement period shall be counted for assessing eligibility for departmental examinations and for annual increment. The GDS shall have NO claim to revert to the previous engagement / recruitment Unit / Division under any circumstances.
- When a GDS is transferred at his/her own request, on approval, he/she shall rank junior in the seniority list of the new unit — to all GDSs of that unit who exist in the seniority list on the date the transfer is ordered — except where the transfer is within the same engagement / recruitment Sub-Division / Unit / Division.

Permitted Level Transfers under LTF

S/No.	Level of GDS	Transfer Allowed (Level of GDS)
1	BPM Level-1	(a) BPM Level-1 in TRCA Slab-2; (b) ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-2 (Postal / RMS) in same TRCA Slab
2	BPM Level-2	BPM Level-2 in TRCA Slab-3
3	ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-1	ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-1 in TRCA Slab-1
4	ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-2	(a) ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-2 in TRCA Slab-2; (b) BPM Level-1 in same TRCA Slab-2 — provided: (i) GDS makes standard accommodation arrangement for managing BO; (ii)

S/No.	Level of GDS	Transfer Allowed (Level of GDS)
		fulfills educational qualification & has adequate knowledge to operate computer / desktop / PoS / mobile; (iii) before joining as BPM Level-1, undergoes prescribed BPM training
5	ABPM / Dak Sevak	ABPM / Dak Sevak from Postal to RMS and vice versa in same TRCA Slab
6	Dak Sevak in RMS	BPM / ABPM / Dak Sevak in same TRCA Level. If joining as BPM, same conditions as in row 4 above apply

Order of Priority — When Multiple Applications for Same Post

- (i) GDS with PwD (having benchmark disabilities);
- (ii) Female GDS — on spouse ground (male spouse working at destination station in Central / State Government or their undertaking / PSU / subordinate organizations — supported by certificate);
- (iii) Male GDS — on spouse ground (female spouse with non-transferable job at destination station in Central / State Government or their undertaking / PSU / subordinate organizations — supported by certificate);
- (iv) Date of engagement (earlier joiners preferred);
- (v) Female (other than spouse ground);
- (vi) Date of birth (older in age preferred);
- (vii) Date & time of application (earlier submission preferred).

Transfer on Vigilance Ground

- A GDS revoked from put-off duty ordinarily shall NOT be posted on the same post; he/she should be transferred to any other vacant post.
- A GDS against whom there are regular complaints substantiated by documentary evidence shall be considered for transfer on vigilance ground.

Transfer on Administrative Ground

- Non-improvement in delivery of services by a GDS — supported by documentary evidence. Before applying this condition, the engaging authority shall ensure that sufficient opportunity has been given in writing to the GDS to improve.

- Abolition of post being held by the GDS due to closure of office / redeployment. Under this condition, to the extent feasible, the GDS shall be transferred to a place / office after taking into consideration his / her written preference.

Conditions of Transfer of GDS (Operational Mapping)

- (i) BPM Level-2 to BPM Level-2 in TRCA Slab-3;
- (ii) BPM Level-1 to BPM Level-1 in TRCA Slab-2;
- (iii) ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-2 to ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-2 in TRCA Slab-2;
- (iv) ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-1 to ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-1 in TRCA Slab-1;
- (v) BPM Level-1 to ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-2 in TRCA Slab-2;
- (v)-a — ABPM / Dak Sevak (Level-2) to BPM (Level-1) in TRCA Slab-2;
- (v)-b — Dak Sevak in RMS units to BPM / ABPM / Dak Sevak in Postal units in same TRCA Slab;
- (v)-c — BPM / ABPM / Dak Sevak in Postal units to Dak Sevak in RMS units in same TRCA Slab.

Important

Transfer of ABPM / Dak Sevak / Dak Sevak in RMS to BPM (Level-1) under the above provisions shall be permitted ONLY on administrative ground — NOT on vigilance ground.

Committee for Transfer & Placement and Process of Transfer

- Transfer within a Sub-Division — Committee comprising Head of Division, ASP (HQ) / Office Superintendent of Divisional Office, and concerned Sub-Divisional Head.
- Transfer within the Division — Committee comprising Head of Division, ASP (HQ) / Office Superintendent, and concerned Sub-Divisional Heads of both Sub-Divisions (where GDS is working and where being transferred).
- Transfer within the Region — Committee comprising Divisional Heads of both Divisions, the concerned Sub-Divisional Head, and another Sub-Divisional Head of the Division concerned.
- The Committee shall NOT recommend transfer of a GDS on administrative / vigilance grounds to a post for which the GDS's own LTF request is pending.

Process of Transfer

- In case of transfer within the Region — the case with full details shall be referred to PMG.
- In case of transfer within Division or within Sub-Division — prior approval of Regional PMG shall be taken by the Divisional Head.
- The Divisional Head shall order transfer only after approval of the minutes of the Transfer & Placement Committee by the Regional PMG. Reasons for any deviation from the Committee's recommendations shall be recorded in file.

Chapter 21 — Issue of Identity Card to GDS

- Identity cards shall be issued FREE OF COST to all Gramin Dak Sevaks engaged after due engagement formalities prescribed in the GDS (C & E) Rules, as amended from time to time.
- A duplicate card may be issued to a GDS where the original is lost / stolen / illegible due to carelessness, by taking a fee of **Rs. 50/-**.
- At the time of Promotion / Discharge / Removal / Dismissal / Death / Transfer (to another Sub-Division / Division), the card shall be returned / surrendered.
- Unique Employee Identity Numbers assigned in CSI shall mandatorily be mentioned on identity cards.
- No identity card shall be issued to a substitute engaged on leave vacancy.
- Identity cards shall be valid for **five years** or till the date of discharge of the GDS, whichever is earlier.
- Fresh identity cards shall be issued after every 5 years.

Chapter 22 — e-Engagement Roll (NEW PROVISION)

MAJOR NEW PROVISION — Introduction of e-Engagement Roll (OM No. 17-12/2025-GDS dated 30.12.2025; rollout 01.04.2026)

The Department has decided to develop an e-Engagement Roll for streamlining the upkeep and maintenance of service records of GDSs. A portal will be developed by CEPT as part of the HRMS module under IT 2.0. The e-Engagement Roll will serve as the OFFICIAL

engagement record for all GDS and will be maintained by the concerned Drawing and Disbursing Officer (DDO). It will comprehensively cover all major service-related events such as engagement, transfer, leave, disciplinary action, financial upgradation, TRCA revision, and final discharge.

Key Features

- The e-Engagement Roll replaces the existing personal-file system maintained on paper.
- For existing GDS as on the date of introduction, the e-Roll shall be prepared on the basis of available service records in a phased manner within 6 MONTHS.
- Each Division shall ensure data entry and uploading of relevant documents for at least 15% of the total working GDS strength PER MONTH, so as to complete the process within 6 months from introduction.
- Upon completion of data entry, the roll shall be transferred to the concerned DDO for subsequent maintenance.
- For GDS engaged on or after 01.04.2026, the e-Engagement Roll shall be prepared directly by the Engaging Authority in the portal, and maintained thereafter by the concerned DDO.
- All Circles are required to instruct Divisions / Units to ensure that compiling of service records / documents of existing GDSs required for the e-Engagement Roll is updated and ready for migration by 31.03.2026.

Maintenance — Where and By Whom

- The Engagement Roll shall be maintained in electronic format in the HRMS module under IT 2.0 by the concerned DDO in the Head Post Office / Head Record Office from which the GDS receives his/her TRCA.
- A copy of the e-Engagement Roll shall also be available in the GDS login for the GDS's information.
- An updated Engagement Roll shall be transferred to the concerned DDO upon transfer of the GDS.

Responsibility & Verification

- It is the responsibility of the Divisional Head and the concerned DDO to ensure that all entries in the e-Engagement Roll are recorded promptly and digitally signed by the Accounts Supervisor (same manner as for regular employees in the HRMS Portal).
- The DDO shall facilitate the GDS in reviewing and verifying the correctness of entries; a declaration regarding correctness shall be obtained from the GDS after each financial year.

Correction of Entries

- No overwriting or erasure of existing entries is permitted.
- If an entry is found incorrect, it must be rectified in the system with provision to view the previous version — duly authenticated by the verifying authority upon uploading of relevant documents.
- All corrections must be duly digitally attested with the digitally signed and dated Attesting Officer (checker-maker system).
- There shall be NO provision to delete any entry made in the e-Engagement Roll.

Annual Verification

- The e-Engagement Roll must be taken up for verification IMMEDIATELY after the close of each financial year by the concerned DDO. Upon satisfactory verification, the designated Attesting Officer (DDO) shall digitally sign the annual Verification Certificate. This exercise shall be completed by **30th June** every year.

Modules of the e-Engagement Roll (14 Modules)

Part / Module	Content Covered
Part-I — Personal Information	Bio-data: name, DOB, parentage, engagement date, caste / community, educational qualification, permanent / correspondence address, PRAN, PAN, Aadhar, GDS ID; recent photograph and signature.
Part-II — Documents & Declarations	GDS Online application printout, mark sheets, community / category / PwD certificate, verification reports, medical fitness certificate, all undertakings,

Part / Module	Content Covered
	offer of provisional engagement, 3-day basic training certificate, joining / charge report, BO accommodation report (BPM only), ID and address proof, family / nomination forms, attestation form.
Part-III — Regularization of Engagement	Order of provisional and regular engagement consequent upon successful verification of all documents; details of resignation, promotion to departmental post, etc.
Part-IV — Record & History of GDS Engagement	Every movement / action in engagement; verified yearly; training, deputation, qualifying period of increment, transfer, financial upgradation, departmental examination.
Part-V — TRCA, Other Payments & Recovery from TRCA	TRCA details, allowances, revisions, fixations, CEFA, bonus, CDA, annual increase, substituted payment against MTS / PM vacant post; all recoveries (union, SDBS / NPS, etc.).
Part-VI — Authorised / Unauthorised Leave & Substitute Details	All periods of paid leave / emergency leave / LWA / unauthorised leave / maternity leave; substitute work duration and payment.
Part-VII — Put-Off Duty / Punishment	Every disciplinary action and its movement / outcome under Rule 10; put-off duty period, punishments awarded, appeals, petitions.
Part-VIII — Promotion, DPC, Departmental Examination	Every event / outcome of promotion, DPC, departmental examination, gradation list.
Part-IX — Financial Upgradation (12 / 24 / 36 years)	Events of financial upgradation under GDSFU Scheme, 2024 with concerned orders.
Part-X — Limited Transfer Facility / Mutual Transfer	Events of transfer under LTF (accepted / rejected) with concerned orders; certificate of verification of engagement on transfer.

Part / Module	Content Covered
Part-XI — TRCA Upgradation / Downgradation (Establishment Review)	All events of TRCA upgradation / downgradation consequent upon Establishment Review with concerned orders.
Part-XII — SDBS / NPS-Lite	PRAN status and number, nomination, subscription details, with concerned orders.
Part-XIII — Discharge / Resignation / Termination / Voluntary Discharge / Medically-Ground Discharge	Every event of cessation along with discharge benefit details.
Part-XIV — Engagement Period — Verification Certificate	Yearly Verification Certificate signed by the Authorised Attesting Officer; no engagement period should remain unverified in any year.

Chapter 23 — Gist of Important DG (Directorate General) Instructions

Reading Note

The following Office Memoranda and Directorate orders are the operative DG instructions most likely to feature in objective and descriptive answers. The list is arranged in reverse chronological order for ease of last-revision tracking.

2026 — Latest Operative Instructions

- **OM No. 17-12/2025-GDS dated 30.12.2025** — Amendment to Rule 7 (Paid Leave): GDS allowed to carry forward unavailed paid leave up to a maximum of 45 days at any given time; 10 days credited at the beginning of each half-year (01.01 / 01.07); 1.67 days credited per completed calendar month; fractions ≥ 0.5 rounded up. NO ENCASHMENT. Effective 01.01.2026.
- **OM No. 17-12/2025-GDS dated 30.12.2025** — Introduction of e-Engagement Roll: HRMS module under IT 2.0; 14 modules; rollout by 01.04.2026; service records of

existing GDSs to be ready for migration by 31.03.2026; phased data entry within 6 months.

- **OM No. 19-19/2024-GDS dated 30.12.2025** — One-Time Relaxation for Compassionate Engagement: Dependents of deceased Departmental Employees / GDSs whose deaths occurred between 01.01.2020 and 24.02.2025 may apply; relaxation valid up to 30.12.2026. CEPT to make provision in CCE portal under APT 2.0.
- **OM dated 26.11.2025** — Revised SEDA: Schedule of Engaging, Disciplinary and Appellate Authority comprehensively revised; effective immediately; pending disciplinary proceedings continue under existing procedure, but penalties imposed by Disciplinary Authority as per revised SEDA; appeals against punishments already awarded decided by Appellate Authorities under pre-revised SEDA.

2025 — Key Operative Instructions

- **OM dated 16.09.2025** — Full power vested in SPM / PM at LSG / HSG-II / HSG-I / NFG levels to grant leave to GDS in their own office.
- **OM No. 19-19/2024-GDS dated 25.02.2025 (Addendum-IV to Compassionate Engagement Scheme 2023)** — Insertion of Para 14-A — Cases of GDSs who quit GDS Seva under the Voluntary Discharge Scheme on Medical Grounds shall also be covered under the Compassionate Engagement Scheme, provided the GDS is discharged on medical grounds before attaining the age of 62 years.
- **OM No. 19-19/2024-GDS dated 25.02.2025** — Comprehensive revision of the Voluntary Discharge Scheme for GDSs on Medical Grounds (modifying OM No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 14.12.2018). Modified scope: intended for GDS suffering contagious disease or bodily / mental infirmity which permanently incapacitates for engagement; Options (A) supernumerary post and (B) voluntary quit with 10-year minimum service for benefits.
- **OM No. 17-01/2017-GDS dated 05.06.2025** — One-time relaxation for processing married-daughter cases in manual mode (registered before introduction of the provision dated 27.06.2024 in the Compassionate Engagement Scheme 2023).

2024 — Key Operative Instructions

- **OM No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 26.11.2024** — Latest clarification: A GDS who is absorbed on a regular post in the Department is NOT eligible for Gratuity. The Severance Amount, however, continues to be payable as per existing scheme on completion of 10 years of continuous engagement.
- **OM dated 27.06.2024 (Addendum)** — Insertion of married daughter as an eligible dependent under the GDS (Compassionate Engagement) Scheme 2023.
- **OM dated 15.03.2024** — Notification of the GDS (Grant of Financial Upgradation) Scheme, 2024 [GDSFU]: Fixed monthly additions of Rs. 360/-, Rs. 460/- and Rs. 600/- on completion of 12 / 24 / 36 years of continuous engagement (cumulative Rs. 360 / Rs. 820 / Rs. 1,420).

2023 — Key Operative Instructions

- **OM No. 17-01/2017-GDS dated 14.06.2023** — Notification of the Gramin Dak Sevaks (Compassionate Engagement) Scheme, 2023, which superseded earlier instructions on engagement of dependents of deceased GDSs on compassionate grounds.

2022 — Key Operative Instructions

- **OM No. 17-02/2018-GDS dated 11.05.2022** — (a) Furnishing of Security under Rule 3-B DELETED. (b) Basic Computer Training: Undertaking declaring adequate computer knowledge to be submitted by the candidate.

2021 — Key Operative Instructions

- **OM dated 01.10.2021** — Restructuring of GDSGIS subscription: Of the Rs. 50/- monthly subscription, Rs. 32.50 goes to Savings Fund and Rs. 17.50 to Insurance Fund (ratio 65 : 35).

2020 — Foundational Instructions

- **OM No. 17-30/2019-GDS dated 14.02.2020** — Issue of the Gramin Dak Sevaks (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020, in supersession of the GDS (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2011.

- **OM dated 28.07.2020** — Original Schedule of Engaging, Disciplinary and Appellate Authority (SEDA) under Rule 31. [Now superseded by the Revised SEDA dated 26.11.2025.]

2019 — Foundational Instructions

- **Directorate letter No. 17-09/2019-GDS dated 26.02.2019** — 10% reservation in engagement to GDS posts for EWSs not covered under SC / ST / OBC reservation.
- **Directorate letter No. 17-08/2017-GDS dated 26.02.2019** — Identification of categories of disability suitable for GDS posts; "Blind" replaced by "Low Vision".
- **Letter No. 17-2/2018-GDS dated 22.03.2019** — Minimum TRCA matrix for all GDS categories by working hours / levels.

2018 — Foundational Instructions

- **Order No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 25.06.2018** — Implementation of recommendations of the One-Man Committee (Kamlesh Chandra Committee) on wages and allowances of GDSs; introduction of new TRCA matrix effective 01.07.2018; revised allowances; SDBS contribution raised to Rs. 300/- per month (equal share from Government and GDS).
- **Order No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 14.12.2018** — Original Voluntary Discharge Scheme for GDSs on Medical Grounds. [Modified by OM dated 25.02.2025.]

Earlier — Foundational Instructions

- **OM No. 19-11/97-ED & TRG dated 27.11.1997** — Adequate representation of SC / ST / OBC communities in GDS engagement.

Chapter 24 — Quick-Reference Charts (Last-Minute Revision)

Important Time Periods at a Glance

Provision	Time Period
Maximum working hours per day for a Sevak	5 hours
Maximum age of retention of a Sevak	65 years

Provision	Time Period
Period of mandatory residence in post village/jurisdiction after selection	1 month
Minimum age for engagement to GDS posts	18 years
Maximum age for engagement to GDS posts	40 years
Period to comply with adequate means of livelihood	30 days after selection (before engagement)
Termination notice period under Rule 8	1 month
Continuous engagement threshold under Rule 8 (eligible for short-notice termination)	Less than 3 years
Paid Leave entitlement per year	20 days (10 + 10 half-yearly)
Paid Leave — credit per completed calendar month	1.67 days
Maximum paid-leave accumulation (carry-forward) at any given time	45 days
Emergency Leave per calendar year	5 days (max. 2 at a time)
Maternity Leave for female GDS	180 days
Period of limitation for Appeal under Rule 14	3 months
Period of limitation for Revision under Rule 19	6 months (subject to proviso)
Put-Off Duty — period before authority can vary ex-gratia	90 days
Put-Off Duty — IP / ASP order auto-expiry (if not Engaging Authority)	15 days
Ex-gratia compensation during Put-Off Duty	25% of TRCA + admissible DA
Maximum variation of ex-gratia after 90 days (increase / decrease)	50% of first-90-day compensation
Voluntary Discharge — minimum service (Scheme-1)	20 years

Provision	Time Period
Voluntary Discharge — minimum service (Scheme-2 / Medical Grounds)	10 years
Voluntary Discharge — notice period (Scheme-1)	3 months
GDS Gratuity / Severance — minimum service	10 years
GDS Gratuity / Severance — maximum (post 01.01.2016)	Rs. 1,50,000/-
Severance per completed year (post 01.01.2016)	Rs. 4,000/-
SDBS — subscription start	After completion of 1 year from date of joining
SDBS — current monthly contribution (each party)	Rs. 300/-
GDSFU — Fixed addition on 12 / 24 / 36 years	Rs. 360 / Rs. 460 / Rs. 600 (cumulative Rs. 360 / 820 / 1,420)
LTF — minimum continuous engagement to apply	2 years
LTF — cooling-off between two successive transfers	1 year
LTF — chances during career (Male / Female)	2 / 3 chances
Mutual Exchange — minimum engagement	1 year
Compassionate Engagement — time limit to apply from date of death	2 years
Compassionate Engagement — missing GDS waiting period	2 years
Compassionate Engagement — minimum age cap for medical-grounds discharge eligibility	Before 62 years
Compassionate Engagement — relaxed criteria max. time to acquire qualification	3 years
Substitute (short-term vacancy threshold)	Up to 45 days

Provision	Time Period
Substitute — beyond 1 year — authority	Head of Region / Head of Circle
Children Education Facilitation Allowance — Divyaang upper age	22 years
CEFA — normal upper age	20 years or passing 12th (whichever earlier)
Identity Card — validity	5 years (or discharge, whichever earlier)
Identity Card — duplicate fee	Rs. 50/-
e-Engagement Roll — Annual Verification deadline	30th June every year
e-Engagement Roll — Pan-India rollout target	01.04.2026

Important Monetary Figures at a Glance

Item	Amount
Application Fee — Male UR / OBC / EWS	Rs. 100/-
Minimum TRCA — BPM Level-1 (4 hours)	Rs. 12,000/-
Minimum TRCA — BPM Level-2 (5 hours)	Rs. 14,500/-
Minimum TRCA — ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-1 (4 hours)	Rs. 10,000/-
Minimum TRCA — ABPM / Dak Sevak Level-2 (5 hours)	Rs. 12,000/-
TRCA fixation factor (Kamlesh Chandra)	2.57
Annual increment rate	3% of TRCA
Ex-gratia Bonus — calculation ceiling	Rs. 7,000/- (basic TRCA + DA)
OMA / Composite Allowance — Standard accommodation	Rs. 500/- p.m.
OMA / Composite Allowance — Non-standard accommodation	Rs. 250/- p.m.

Item	Amount
Fixed Stationery Charge (ABPM / Dak Sevak)	Rs. 25/- p.m.
Boat Allowance	Rs. 115/- p.m.
Cycle Maintenance Allowance	Rs. 180/- p.m.
Risk & Hardship Allowance	Rs. 500/- p.m.
GDSGIS Insurance Amount	Rs. 50,000/-
GDSGIS Monthly Premium	Rs. 50/- (Savings 32.50 + Insurance 17.50)
GDS Gratuity — maximum (w.e.f. 01.01.2016)	Rs. 1,50,000/-
Severance Amount per year (w.e.f. 01.01.2016)	Rs. 4,000/-
Severance Amount — maximum (w.e.f. 01.01.2016)	Rs. 1,50,000/-
CEFA per child per annum	Rs. 6,000/- (fixed)
GDSFU — 12 years addition	Rs. 360/- p.m.
GDSFU — 24 years cumulative addition	Rs. 820/- p.m.
GDSFU — 36 years cumulative addition	Rs. 1,420/- p.m.
SDBS Subscription (each — GDS and Govt.)	Rs. 300/- p.m.

Distinguishing Removal vs Dismissal

Feature	Removal [Rule 9(8)]	Dismissal [Rule 9(9)]
Nature of Penalty	Major	Major
Disqualification for future engagement	Shall NOT be a disqualification	ORDINARILY shall be a disqualification
Severity	Less severe	More severe

Distinguishing Termination vs Removal vs Dismissal vs Voluntary Discharge

Mode of Cessation	Governing Rule	Continuous Engagement Required	Notice	GDS Gratuity / Severance
Termination	Rule 8	Less than 3 years	1 month (or pay in lieu)	NOT eligible
Removal	Rule 9(8)	Any duration	Not applicable (after Rule 10 procedure)	As applicable (no disqualification for future)
Dismissal	Rule 9(9)	Any duration	Not applicable (after Rule 10 procedure)	Ordinarily disqualified
Voluntary Discharge (Scheme-1)	Rule 3-C	20 years	3 months	Eligible (proportionate)
Voluntary Discharge — Medical (Scheme-2)	Rule 3-C r/w OM 25.02.2025	10 years	On medical certification	Eligible (proportionate)
Compulsory Discharge	Rule 9(7)	Any (after major penalty proceedings)	Not applicable	Eligible (proportionate)

Chapter 25 — Examination-Oriented Pointers

Common Trap Points — Beware

- (1) **Voluntary Discharge minimum service:** Scheme-1 is **20 years**; Scheme-2 (Medical) is **10 years** — students often confuse these two.
- (2) **Carry-forward of paid leave is NEW (w.e.f. 01.01.2026)** — the pre-2026 position was "no carry-forward, no encashment". The amendment introduces carry-forward up to 45 days, but NOT encashment.

- (3) **Mandatory inquiry under 10-D** is required EVEN IF the GDS accepts the charges for MAJOR penalty — UNLESS the GDS accepts the charges UNCONDITIONALLY.
- (4) **Put-Off Duty by IP/ASP in fraud/embezzlement cases:** the order ceases on expiry of **15 days** if not confirmed by the Engaging Authority.
- (5) **Period of limitation for revision under Rule 19:** 6 months from order — BUT cannot be reopened before the 3-month appeal-period under Rule 14 has expired.
- (6) **Strike period implications:** a 7-fold consequence (TRCA deducted, no DA/bonus, no leave regularisation, possible break in engagement, no qualifying for Gratuity/Severance, no qualifying for MTS absorption, no qualifying for LDCE).
- (7) **SDBS forfeiture:** On Dismissal and Removal, all accrued accumulations in the Permanent Retirement Account are FORFEITED.
- (8) **Disability category exclusion:** The combined category of "Deaf-and-Blindness" is the only multiple-disability combination EXCLUDED from engagement to GDS posts. "Low Vision" (LV) has replaced "Blind".
- (9) **Compassionate engagement — relaxed criteria:** Provisional engagement with 3-year deadline to acquire qualification; only minimum TRCA payable; no annual increment till qualification acquired; transfer not allowed for 2 years from regularisation.
- (10) **LTF chances:** Refusal to accept Limited Transfer Order counts as ONE chance; withdrawal within window period does NOT count. Male: 2 chances; Female: 3 chances.
- (11) **Severance vs Gratuity migration:** Per OM dated 26.11.2024, a GDS absorbed on a regular departmental post is NOT eligible for Gratuity. (Severance is paid in cash if 10 years completed; SDBS accumulations migrate to NPS Tier-1.)

Memory Aids — Quick Recall

- **Rule 9 sequence** — Penalties (1)–(5) MINOR; (6)–(9) MAJOR. "Censure–Debar PA/SA–Debar MTS Sr.–Recovery–Withhold Increase" (Minor); "Reduce TRCA–Compulsory Discharge–Removal–Dismissal" (Major).

- **Rule 10 architecture** — 10-A (Minor procedure) | 10-B (Major procedure) | 10-C (Record) | 10-D (Mandatory inquiry for Major) | 10-E (Discretionary inquiry for Minor) | 10-F (After-discharge, proceedings instituted before discharge) | 10-G (After-discharge, proceedings NOT instituted before discharge — needs President's sanction).
- **Conduct Rules numbering** — Rule 21 to Rule 29A: 21 General | 21-A Promptness/Courtesy | 21-B Sexual Harassment | 22 Politics/Elections | 23 Strikes | 24 Criticism of Govt. | 25 Evidence | 26 Unauthorised Communication | 27 Insolvency | 28 Vindication | 29 Canvassing | 29-A Detrimental Business.
- **SEDA — quick recall** — Revised on 26.11.2025. Category 1 (PSs Gr B–STS, below JAG) → Engaging = Disciplinary = Head of Division/Unit; Appellate = PMG/DPS. Category 2 (JAG and above) → Engaging = Disciplinary = Dy. Director / Asst. Director; Appellate = Head of Division/Unit. Minor penalties (i–v) may be imposed by Sr.PM / HSG-I PM / SDI in their own office.
- **Paid Leave 2026 onwards** — 20 days p.a. (10 + 10) | Carry-forward up to 45 days | NO encashment | 1.67 days per completed month | Rounding 0.5 or above = 1 day.
- **e-Engagement Roll** — 14 modules | HRMS / IT 2.0 | DDO maintains | Rollout 01.04.2026 | Annual verification by 30 June | No deletion permitted.

Chapter 26 — Acknowledgement & Sources

This study material has been compiled by Dak Guru (DG InfoTech) by collation of:

- The principal statutory instrument — Gramin Dak Sevaks (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020 — issued vide OM No. 17-30/2019-GDS dated 14.02.2020.
- All material amending Office Memoranda and Directorate orders up to May 2026.
- The Department of Posts website (www.indiapost.gov.in) and authoritative reference compilations.

Suggestions for improvement of this study material are welcome. Please write to us through the Dak Guru portal — www.dakguru.com — under the Community section.

All the Best!

We wish you the very best in your LDCE / departmental examination journey. Consistent, focused revision of the Rules and the latest OMs — particularly the four major amendments brought in during 2025–2026 (Carry-forward of Paid Leave, Revised SEDA, e-Engagement Roll, One-Time Compassionate Engagement Relaxation) — will give you a clear edge over the competition. Always read this material together with the original Government orders.

Dak Guru — your trusted self-preparation companion.

